What a grammar of records fixes: a modular flavour triplet, its couplings, and the boundary of what it leaves free

origin-axiom

Draft 3 (internal), October 16, 2026

Abstract

We ask what a minimal principle of existence fixes once it is given a mathematical form, and we price everything it does not.

The principle is non-cancellation: what exists is what remains when cancelling to nothing cannot complete. We give it a chosen form, a grammar of two integer records acted on by two unit moves and their pull-backs. Every primitive hyperbolic closed path of the moves is a thread, a closed geodesic on the modular surface. We study all threads at once, as one joint action, the weave.

On the weave we show four things, each in a stated range: the first for words to length six, the other three in stated frames.

- The records' three parities carry a flavour triplet, proved to word length six. Its symmetry is the multiplier of the weight-one theta triplet of $\Gamma(4)$, twisted by a character of η, and up to a monomial intertwiner and a choice of hand.
- In the fibre frame, given the triplet postulate, every single-point coupling on that triplet has the triplet's isotropic vector as a two-sided null vector. This is a structural zero in one frame, not a prediction of a massless fermion.
- In a twisted frame the coupling's determinant and adjugate factor exactly through the Higgs's and the matter's defects. The product of the three masses factors through two defects and one pairing.
- Given the triplet postulate, one unit at the cusp and an extreme choice of boundary domain, on a stated reading of the weave's surface, the four-dimensional index is ± 3. A domain respecting the weave's symmetry allows ± 1 as well.

The same structure fixes none of the Standard Model's thirteen flavour numbers, and we locate where each must be supplied. A census of one Higgs at the symmetric point, a scoreboard on seen data, fits the five non-electron mass ratios on none of the admissible lines. The miss is the down–lepton ratio $(m_\mu/m_\tau)/(m_s/m_b)$.

The motion of the grammar, read through B1663 (sealed) and B1666 (a scoreboard, sealed after B1664 and B1665 failed their gates), gives three results.

- The pull-back's strength sets the side and the speed of the motion, but not the defect it averages, to the test's resolution.
- Averaged by trace up to trace 600, the threads approach the modular surface's constant mode, as equidistribution requires (a check of the instrument).
- The matter amplitude's coherence decays, and the normalised coherence of the cusp family climbs toward one (a read-out).

No value of the Standard Model is derived. Every input the results use is listed in one table, with what it buys and what would discharge it.

1 Introduction

The question. Why is there something rather than nothing, and why this something? We do not answer either half. We ask a narrower question that can be answered: if existence is taken to

be the minimal thing that is not nothing, what does that minimum force, and what does it leave free? The answer has two halves. Given the chosen form and the inputs of Table 1, structure follows. The "which" is not fixed by it: every number that would single out our world has to be supplied, and no frame on record is shown to fix one. We locate each of those numbers, and we price each thing we assume.

The principle. We start from one sentence: *existence is what remains when cancelling to nothing cannot complete*. We read it as a grammar of records.

- Two integers (a, b) are acted on by two unit moves, $L : (a, b) \mapsto (a, a + b)$ and $R : (a, b) \mapsto (a + b, b)$, and by their pull-backs L^{-1} and R^{-1}.
- The non-cancellation is a commutator. The two two-step words LR and RL generate the commutator subgroup of $\mathrm{SL}(2, \mathbb{Z})$, the fundamental group of a once-punctured torus. Their commutator, the two steps followed by their two pull-backs, does not return to the start: its trace is -2, and the attempt to cancel lands on the puncture, with a sign (Proposition 1).
- A primitive hyperbolic closed path of the moves is a *thread*: a conjugacy class of $\mathrm{SL}(2, \mathbb{Z})$, a closed geodesic on the modular surface. The first such path that mixes the records is $A = LR$, the monodromy of the figure-eight knot's complement. Under four stated inputs it is unique (Theorem 2).

We do not study one thread. We study all of them at once, the joint action of the moves on the records, which we call the *weave*. Every result below is a statement about the weave, or is marked as a statement about one thread.

What is forced, and what holds given inputs.

1. **A flavour triplet** (§3). The moves permute the records' three non-zero parities as S_3, on every thread. The odd-trace threads receive the binary tetrahedral group $2T$ at the threads' common point, acting irreducibly on the three parity lines: proved for every odd-trace word. The arithmetic of that point (a prime above 3) is a census law to length eight.
2. **The triplet is modular** (§4). The moves' action on the triplet is the multiplier of $\eta^{21}(\theta_2^2, \theta_3^2, \theta_4^2)$: the weight-one theta triplet of $\Gamma(4)$, the triplet of modular flavour models [1], twisted by a character of η and up to a monomial intertwiner. Up to a stated choice of hand and a power of the eta character, the grammar's symmetry is a classical modular symmetry.
3. **A structural zero in the fibre frame** (§5). On the fibre, given the triplet postulate, the zero modes' pairing triplet is isotropic at every point (Jacobi's $\theta_3^4 = \theta_2^4 + \theta_4^4$), so every single-point coupling has a two-sided null vector. The statement is frame-dependent, and we say where it fails. The hierarchy of the other two is the coupling's distance from the isotropic cone.
4. **The masses factor through two defects** (Theorem 20). In the twisted frame the coupling's determinant and adjugate factor exactly:

$$\det Y = 4 \det S \, \det M \, \mathrm{tr}(\epsilon S M^T), \qquad \mathrm{adj}\, Y = \det S \, A(M) + \det M \, P \, A(S).$$

   The product of the masses factors through the Higgs's defect, the matter's defect and their pairing; the squared masses are the roots of a cubic whose other two coefficients are norms of the coupling.

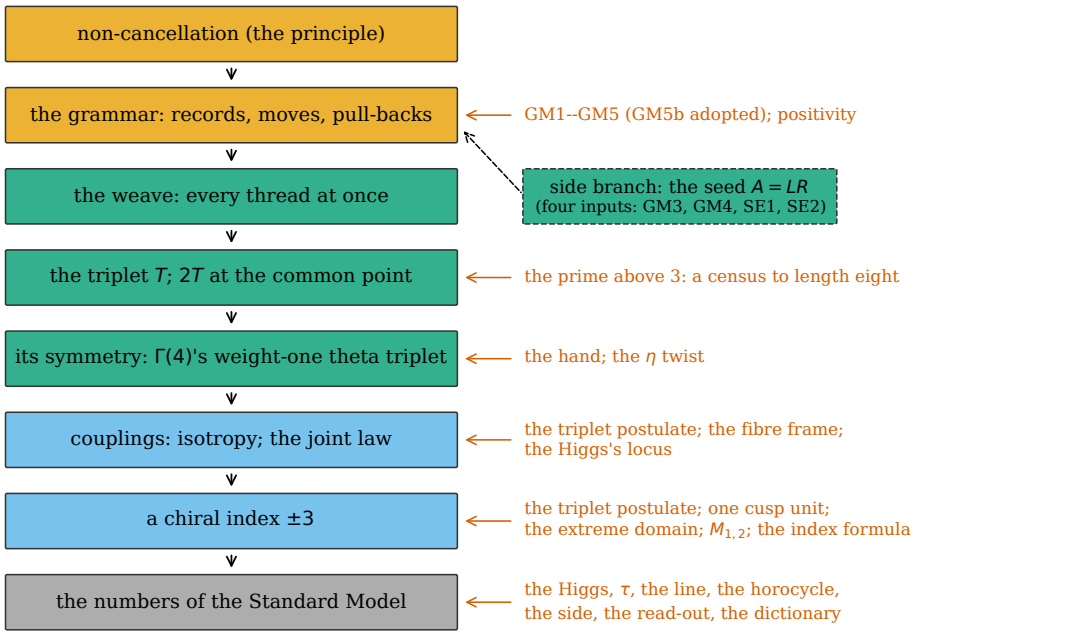


Figure 1: The chain and its prices: what follows from the stated inputs of its section (green), what is stated (orange), what also needs tagged postulates (blue), and what is open (grey). Inputs enter from the right. The seed is a side branch of the grammar. A drawn schematic of Table 1.

5. **A chiral index ±3, given its inputs** (§6). With the triplet postulate, one unit at the cusp and an extreme boundary domain, on $M_{1,2}$ read as the weave's surface, the four-dimensional index is ±3. The 3 is the postulated triplet's dimension, and a domain respecting the weave's symmetry allows ±1 as well.

What is not. The same structure fixes none of the Standard Model's thirteen flavour numbers (§7). The boundary is as sharp as the forced half:

- in the frames where the inner automorphisms act, every residual subgroup of the weave's group either degenerates the masses or leaves them free, and none that reduces the count of mixing parameters is compatible with the CKM data at 3σ;
- no frame on record is shown to satisfy all of the principle's demands;
- a sealed census finds that one Higgs at the symmetric point $\tau = \omega$ reproduces the five non-electron mass ratios on none of the admissible lines. The miss is the down–lepton ratio $(m_\mu/m_\tau)/(m_s/m_b)$, which the data put at 3.14;
- whatever chooses the numbers is not given by the symmetry alone, although it acts at a symmetric point.

The motion. The grammar's states move. A random walk of steps and pull-backs escapes at a positive rate: for equal weights by the theorems of Kesten and Furstenberg, and at the other weights by Furstenberg's theorem, since the support generates $\mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$; the values are

measured. Two sealed arcs read that motion: B1663, and B1666, a scoreboard computed after the gates of B1664 and B1665 had failed and their read-outs had been seen.

- The pull-back's strength sets the probability of the side the end lies on (from 1.000 to 0.531) and the speed, but not the defect it averages, to the test's resolution (B1663).
- Averaged trace by trace, the threads approach the modular surface's constant mode (0.3144 at the largest traces against 0.31500491, the gap shrinking as $t^{-0.51\pm0.05}$, a read-out): the weave side of the trace formula comes out where the wave side says, as equidistribution requires (a check of the instrument).
- The matter amplitude carries the Higgs's character. The normalised coherence of the cusp family $L^{4m+1}R$ climbs toward one, and the root LR is not singled out (a read-out; the size of the coherent amplitude is not compared).

These are statements about the mathematics of the motion. We do not claim the motion is physical.

The record. The computations are archived in a public repository [2]. A label such as B1659 names one computation there (an *arc*), with its preregistration, instrument, output and *lock*, a test in the repository's suite that fails if the result changes. A *scoreboard* is a result computed on data that were already seen, and is called so. A *tagged* input is a working postulate whose results carry the word "given". The program's work runs on several parallel lines on the same record; their cross-checks are internal to the program, not external review.

The price. Every input is stated in Table 1, with what it buys and what would discharge it: the principle, the grammar and the root's two conditions, one adopted reading, the choices (positivity, orientation, the boundary domain, the frame, the modulus and the lines, the canonical horocycle, the hand and the η twist, the Higgs's type and locus), the tagged postulates, the readings (the weave's surface, the modular-flavour ansatz, the index formula), and the identifications that turn structure into physics. No value of the Standard Model is derived: none of its nineteen parameters. We built the computations as sealed tests: each preregistered, run once per sealed version, and its output committed before it was read. The paper keeps its failures, including two failed gates of our own (§9).

Reading. The principle asks for something that cannot cancel. The grammar's answer is a motion: steps and their pull-backs that never settle. The structure that motion carries is forced. What it leaves free is the choice of a world.

2 The grammar and the seed

The question. The principle says that existence is what remains when cancelling to nothing cannot complete. To ask what that forces, the sentence has to be given a form in which something can be computed. This section gives it one: two records, two moves and their pull-backs. It then asks the first question the form can answer, namely what the first description is that mixes the two records and does not cancel. The answer is a theorem with four stated inputs, and the section discloses how the answer was known before the inputs were written. All results of the program are cited by their arcs in the repository [2].

The principle. We use the single wording of the record: existence is what remains when cancelling to nothing cannot complete (PF1); that remainder is a description that cannot be exhausted (PF2); the program reads that description as mathematical structure and asks what it forces (PF3). The three are postulated, as three faces of one commitment, and nothing in the

record derives one from another. The mathematical face of PF1 is a reading, not a derivation. For two letters a, b of the once-punctured torus group it is the Fricke–Vogt invariant $\kappa = \operatorname{tr}[a, b]$, and cancelling to nothing completes where $\kappa = 2$. The wording is therefore that a description *generically does not cancel* ($\kappa \neq 2$), never that it cannot.

The grammar. A *description* is built from two integer records, $(a, b) \in \mathbb{Z}^2$. The grammar has five items.

- *Records and moves* (GM1, GM2). An update acts on the pair of records. The elementary updates are the unit shears

$$L = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} : (a, b) \mapsto (a, a + b), \qquad R = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} : (a, b) \mapsto (a + b, b),$$

  and a description is a word in them. Every hyperbolic class of $\mathrm{SL}(2, \mathbb{Z})$ is, up to sign, a cyclic word in L and R containing both letters (a classical fact [3]; checked for all 168 hyperbolic matrices with entries up to 5 in the record's B1516).

- *Aperiodicity* (GM3). The description does not repeat, so the monodromy is hyperbolic.

- *The carrier* (GM4). Words are realized as mapping classes of the once-punctured torus, whose first homology is $\mathbb{Z}^2$.

- *Reversible updates* (GM5a), with the unit shears of GM2.

- *The pull-back* (GM5b). The inverse moves L^{-1} and R^{-1} are legal updates.

GM5b is adopted as a reading of PF1's own cancelling, chosen on the mathematics (B1662); it is not a derivation. In PF1's form $\kappa = \operatorname{tr}[a, b]$ the commutator is two letters followed by their two inverses. Among the moves the same shape is the commutator of LR and RL, which freely generate the commutator subgroup of $\mathrm{SL}(2, \mathbb{Z})$, the fundamental group of the modular once-punctured torus. This is classical; the paper's check script confirms it (both words lie in the kernel of the abelianisation $\mathrm{SL}(2, \mathbb{Z}) \to \mathbb{Z}/12$, and a coset enumeration gives the subgroup they generate index 12). Note that the commutator of the single letters is not of this kind: $\operatorname{tr}[L, R] = 3$. The next two statements are the facts the adoption rests on. Both are finite matrix computations.

Proposition 1 (the failed cancellation and the sign)**.** *At the root the commutator of the two products LR and RL does not return to the identity. It equals $-U$ with U unipotent, so its trace is -2: the cancellation lands on the cusp, with a sign. The sign itself is generated by the moves and their pull-backs,*

$$-I = (L\,R^{-1}L)^2 = (L^{-1}R)^3.$$

Proof. Direct multiplication. $[LR, RL] = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} -7 & 6 \\ -6 & 5 \end{smallmatrix}\right) = -U$ with $U = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 7 & -6 \\ 6 & -5 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, which has trace 2 and is not the identity. Next, $LR^{-1}L = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ squares to $-I$, and $L^{-1}R = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ has order six with cube $-I$. The square $(LR^{-1}L)^2 = -I$ is unchanged when L and R are replaced by their inverses (the mirror, B1662). The two elements fix the points i and $\omega = e^{2\pi i/3}$ of the upper half-plane, and no word in L, R alone reaches them: a word in L, R has non-negative entries, so $ad = 1 + bc \geq 1$ forces $a, d \geq 1$, and its trace is 2 only when $a = d = 1$, otherwise at least 3; a finite order element has trace 0 or ± 1. □

The record reads the trace -2 through classical results and uses them only for what they say. On the character variety of the once-punctured torus the trace of the commutator is $x^2 + y^2 + z^2 - xyz - 2$ in the traces $(x, y, z) = (\operatorname{tr} a, \operatorname{tr} b, \operatorname{tr} ab)$ (Fricke's identity), and -2 is the value at which the commutator is parabolic: the puncture. The modular group's action on these characters is studied in [4], and the classification of the punctured-torus groups is in [5]. We use the two references to name the setting and nothing more.

The direction of the moves. Three consequences of GM5b are readings, kept apart from the theorems.

- *The sign is generated.* Proposition 1 shows that a full turn about a balance point negates both records. The place where a hand can be registered on a spin structure (B1479, B1481) is generated by the moves.
- *Positivity is the choice of side.* Step and pull-back are mirror images: conjugation by $\mathrm{diag}(1,-1)$ sends L to L^{-1}, R to R^{-1} and τ to $-\bar{\tau}$. The restriction to non-negative counts, which an earlier form of the grammar stated as a rule on states, is therefore a selection of one side of the mirror. It stays a chosen input. Under the pull-back the reachable updates are $\mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$, and every hyperbolic class keeps a forward representative, so no statement about the threads changes.
- *The arrow is the escape.* A random walk with steps $L^{\pm1}, R^{\pm1}$ at equal strength is transient on $\mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$, since the group is non-amenable [6], and it escapes at a positive linear rate [7, 8]. These cover the symmetric walk; for the unequal weights of Section 7 the rate is positive by Furstenberg's theorem, since the support generates $\mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$, and its values are measured (B1663). The reading in which the pull-back only undoes the last step is recurrent at equal strength. So only the reading adopted here never settles at equal strength, and the arrow is the escape, a positive rate with no preferred side. We cite the two theorems and do not use the walk below until Section 7.

The seed. The first description that mixes the two records is a product of both unit moves. To see what the grammar selects, let the increments of the shears vary: $L_a = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & a \\ 0 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, $R_b = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ b & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ with integers $a, b \geq 1$, and set $B(a,b) = L_a R_b = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1+ab & a \\ b & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$. The selection criterion SE1 asks that the first homology of the mapping torus be torsion-free. Orientation (SE2) takes the orientable one of the two classes that SE1 leaves.

Theorem 2 (the seed, T1)**.** *Take GM3 (aperiodicity), GM4 (the once-punctured-torus carrier), SE1 (a torsion-free first homology) and SE2 (the orientable choice). Then the root, the first mixed persistent sector, is the monodromy*

$$A = LR = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \operatorname{tr} A = 3,$$

up to the order bit LR against RL, and its mapping torus is the complement of the figure-eight knot. In particular, on the positive grid $1 \leq a, b \leq 12$ all 144 closures $B(a,b)$ are hyperbolic and exactly one is torsion-free, $(a,b) = (1,1)$.

Proof (sketch; the record's uniqueness theorem, B1323, B1454). For $B \in \mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$ one has $\det(B - I) = 2 - \operatorname{tr} B$, and the mapping torus has $H_1 = \mathbb{Z} \oplus \operatorname{coker}(B - I)$. Hence for $B(a,b)$: $\operatorname{tr} B = 2 + ab$, which exceeds 2 for every $a, b \geq 1$ (so all 144 are hyperbolic), and the torsion of H_1 has order ab. It is trivial exactly when $ab = 1$, that is $(a,b) = (1,1)$ and $B = LR$. On the full set of states, torsion of order $|2 - \operatorname{tr}|$ vanishes only for trace 3 among the hyperbolic classes (GM3 excludes the elliptic trace 1), and the trace-3 class is that of LR (checked for every unimodular matrix with entries up to 5, B1516 C2; the general statement is the class-number-one fact for discriminant 5 [9]). When orientation-reversing monodromies are admitted, the torsion has order $|\operatorname{tr}|$ and the torsion-free classes are those of LR and of the golden matrix LP (determinant -1, trace ± 1, with $(LP)^2 = LR$), whose bundle is the Gieseking manifold $m000$. SE2 takes the orientable one, $m004$, the orientation double cover of $m000$. The mapping torus of LR is the figure-eight complement [10, 11]. The words route (aperiodic $\Rightarrow$ Sturmian $\Rightarrow$ the golden matrix) and the records route are one construction in two presentations (B1323; B1607 for the principle's tick). □

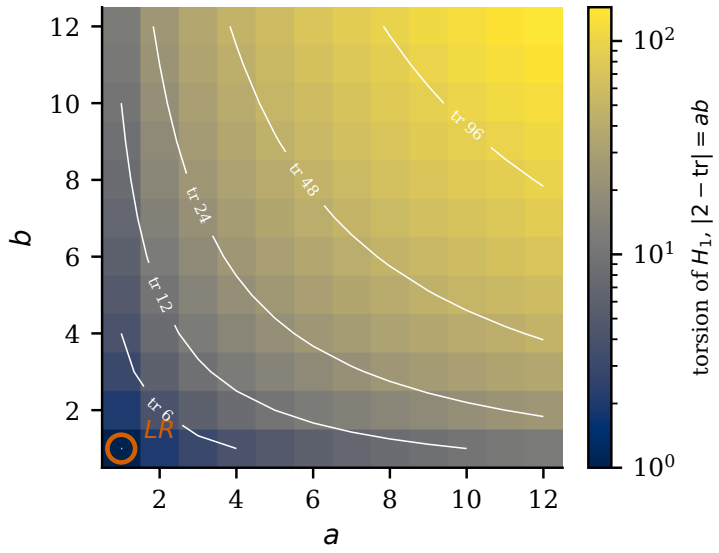


Figure 2: The seed is forced: $144 \to 1$. Torsion order $|2 - \operatorname{tr} B(a,b)| = ab$ of H_1 over the 12×12 grid of closures (colour, logarithmic), with contours of the trace $2 + ab$. The root LR, $(a,b) = (1,1)$, is the only torsion-free closure. This is an exact computation on the grid, conditional on the inputs of Theorem 2.

Scope. The theorem is conditional on its four inputs, and each is needed: without GM3 the order-six monodromy of trace 1 (the trefoil complement) and the parabolic monodromies of trace 2 also satisfy SE1; without GM4 the closed torus bundle of LR, which is torsion-free, remains; without SE1 every state remains (758 to word length 12); without SE2 the parent $m000$ remains. Positivity (the choice of the forward side), minimality of the trace, the unit-shear generation GM2 and the order bit are not needed for the root. The root's uniqueness holds with and without positivity: without it the torsion-free hyperbolic solutions are $(1,1)$ and $(-1,-1)$, in one class (B1454). The theorem selects one *thread* of the family that the grammar allows. It does not make that thread privileged, and no later result in the paper uses it as a premise.

Provenance. The root was known before the axioms were written: the figure-eight complement was named in a probe, and the grammar was written afterwards. The genesis is therefore a conditional reconstruction of a chosen sector, not a derivation of the figure-eight from nothing. We say so here because a reader will otherwise suspect it. No input of Table 1 is derived from a weaker one in the record, and none of the three further anchors proposed within the program for the genesis is graded proved in the record (one is refuted, two are conditional).

The inputs. Table 1 lists every input this paper uses, with its status, what it buys and what would discharge it. The last lines of the table state the price as the record counts it.

Reading. The arena. SE1 has two solutions: trace 3, the root, and trace 1, the order-six move $L^{-1}R$ whose mapping torus is the trefoil complement. Under the pull-back the second is reached by the moves (it fixes ω), and GM3 keeps it from being a thread. We read the root as the motion and the trace-1 solution as the arena the motion moves in: $\mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{R})/\mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$ is the complement of the trefoil [12], and the closed orbits of its geodesic flow are the threads [13]. The classical facts are cited, and nothing in the paper is derived from this reading.

3 The weave

The question. The grammar allows many descriptions, not one. Section 2 selected one of them as a root, under four inputs. The honest form of the question "what is forced" is what holds for all the descriptions at once, with none picked by hand. This section names the descriptions, names their joint action, and finds the first structure that the joint action forces: the records' own parities, which move as three objects and which give a triplet. The program's arcs are cited by number [2].

Threads. A *thread* is a closed path of the moves through the shared records. Concretely it is a primitive hyperbolic conjugacy class $\pm w$ in $\mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$, where w is a cyclic word in L and R containing both letters; such classes exhaust the hyperbolic classes (Section 2). A thread is also a closed geodesic on the modular surface $\mathbb{H}/\mathrm{PSL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$, and the word is its cutting sequence [3, 14]. Its once-punctured-torus bundle is a cusped hyperbolic 3-manifold. The root LR of Theorem 2 is one thread, of trace 3.

Definition 3 (the weave)**.** The *weave* is the joint action of every allowed move on the records, together with everything that joint action forces. A *weave statement* takes every thread under a rule stated in advance, with none chosen, is defined by the joint action, and is a claim about all threads at once. A *thread statement* is anything read on one thread or on its covers, and is labelled so.

Every statement below is labelled in this way. Theorem 2 and the frames of the later sections are thread statements. The next paragraphs are weave statements, and their ranges are stated: "every thread" always means every thread under a stated bound on the word length.

Three, from parity. Reduce the records modulo 2. The group $\mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{F}_2)$ acts on the three non-zero vectors of $\mathbb{F}_2^2$, the three *parities* $(1,0),(0,1),(1,1)$, as the symmetric group S_3. Nothing is put in to make three: $2^2-1=3$.

Lemma 4 (the parity lemma)**.** *With the grammar's action $(a,b)\mapsto(a,a+b)$, L fixes the parity $(0,1)$ and exchanges the other two; R fixes $(1,0)$; the swap $P:(a,b)\mapsto(b,a)$ of the two records (not a move of the ruled grammar; see below) fixes $(1,1)$; the sign $-I$ fixes all three. Any two of L, R and the swap generate S_3 on the three parities. For $\phi\in\mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$, $\operatorname{tr}\phi$ is odd if and only if ϕ acts on the parities as a 3-cycle.*

Proof. Modulo 2, L and R are the transvections $\left(\begin{smallmatrix}1&1\\0&1\end{smallmatrix}\right)$ and $\left(\begin{smallmatrix}1&0\\1&1\end{smallmatrix}\right)$, which are transpositions of the three non-zero vectors; two distinct transpositions generate S_3. An element of $\mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{F}_2)$ of order three has characteristic polynomial x^2+x+1, hence trace 1; the identity and the transpositions have trace 0. □

The lemma is exact for every word. The record also checked it on all 988 signed words to length eight (448 of odd trace; B1600). Thus the three parities are cycled by every thread of odd trace, with no thread chosen, and a thread of even trace fixes at least one of them.

The common point. For a thread, take the traces $(x,y,z)=(\operatorname{tr}a,\operatorname{tr}b,\operatorname{tr}ab)$ of the fibre's holonomy at the geometric point. The Fricke maps of L and R act on the parabolic surface $x^2+y^2+z^2=xyz$ (commutator trace -2, the puncture), and on this surface their only common fixed point is the origin $(0,0,0)$, the *quaternion point*: there the holonomy sends $a\mapsto i$ and $b\mapsto j$ in the quaternion group $Q_8\subset\mathrm{SU}(2)$ (B1600, W2). We call it the *common point*. It is the point at which every odd-trace thread meets the same finite picture.

The common point is also the geometry modulo three. For a thread with odd trace the ideal generated by (x,y,z) in the ring of integers of $\mathbb{Q}(x,y,z)$ is, on every thread to word length eight,

one prime of residue degree one above 3, of norm 3 and multiplicity one. The holonomy reduces modulo that prime to the quaternion point, and the cover that forces the binary tetrahedral group $2T = \mathrm{SL}(2, \mathbb{F}_3)$ is the thread's principal congruence cover at it. For even trace the ideal is a power of a prime above 2, and the common point is the trivial representation (B1601).

Census law 5 (the geometry modulo three, B1601)**.** Call a *geometry* the bundle of a thread up to the symmetries that preserve it (cyclic rotation and the exchange of L and R), so that each is computed once. On all 37 geometries of word length at most eight (16 of odd trace, 21 of even trace), an odd-trace thread has the prime above 3 described above, and an even-trace thread has no prime above 3. The linearized lemma behind it is proved: the Fricke maps' linear parts at the common point are quarter turns about the x- and y-axes of the three parity lines, generating the rotations of the cube, and a word has odd trace if and only if its linear part is a third turn about a body diagonal, an axis isotropic for $x^2 + y^2 + z^2$ exactly in characteristic three. That odd trace *always* gives this prime, and even trace never, is not proved for all words.

The parity triplet. The moves act on the three parities, and the common point carries $2T$. Together they give a triplet.

Theorem 6 (the parity triplet, T2)**.** *1.* ***(Parity.)*** *The moves act on the three non-zero parities of the two records as S_3, and a thread has odd trace if and only if it acts as a 3-cycle (Lemma 4; every word).*

2. ***(The common point.)*** *For every odd-trace word, there is an element $\tau \in 2T \setminus Q_8$ conjugating (i, j) to the images of the thread's generators, and the group generated by i, j, τ is $2T$, of order 24. The group acts on the three parity lines as the standard three-dimensional irreducible representation of $A_4 = 2T/\{\pm 1\}$ (character $(3, -1, 0, 0)$, norm one). For an even-trace word the conjugator lies in Q_8 if the word acts trivially on the parities, and in the binary octahedral group $2O$ outside $2T$ if it acts as a transposition; the parity lines split. The arithmetic of the common point, a prime above 3, is Census law 5.*

3. ***(The zero modes.)*** *On the weave's surface $M_{1,2}$ (taken as a reading, Table 1), let V be the parity-twisted spin space. The group generated by the lifts of L and R on $V = T \oplus \bar{T}$ has order 96. The Hodge–Riemann form on V is invariant under L, R and the sign, has signature $(3, 3)$ and is positive definite on T. The punctured fibre with this local system has three holomorphic zero modes, one per parity, and they span T.*

Proof (records B1600, B1606, B1624). (1) is Lemma 4. (2) The Fricke maps fix the common point, so for a word φ the representation $\rho \circ \varphi$ of the free group, with $\rho(a) = i$ and $\rho(b) = j$, has the character of ρ. It is irreducible, so $\rho \circ \varphi = g\rho g^{-1}$ for some $g \in \mathrm{SU}(2)$, determined up to sign. Then g normalises Q_8, so g lies in $2O$, the normaliser of Q_8 in $\mathrm{SU}(2)$. The class of g in $2O/Q_8 \cong S_3 \cong \mathrm{Out}(Q_8)$ is the action of φ on the parities. So $g \in 2T \setminus Q_8$ exactly when the trace is odd (Lemma 4), $g \in Q_8$ when φ is trivial modulo 2, and $g \in 2O \setminus 2T$ for a transposition; for odd trace $\langle i, j, g \rangle = 2T$. The record checks this with exact rational quaternion matrices for every word of length at most six (B1600); the first attempt with irrational entries failed an equality test because of an error in the instrument, caught by an impossible group order and corrected before anything was read off. The triplet is then a statement of representation theory: $h^1(F; \chi_\varepsilon) = 1$ for each non-zero parity ε (the twisted cohomology of the punctured torus), and $A_4 = (\mathbb{Z}/2)^2 \rtimes \mathbb{Z}/3$ permutes the three non-trivial characters of $(\mathbb{Z}/2)^2$ cyclically, which is the standard irreducible three. For an involution the representation splits. (3) The cup product on the $\mathbb{Z}/2$-orbifold presentation of the fibre group, by an independent implementation, gives the form and its signature; the zero modes are $F = (f(z), f(z+\tau))\, dz$ with $f = \theta_3(z; 2\tau)/\sqrt{\theta_1(z; \tau)}$ and the three parity twists $F_p = C_p F$. □

Scope. Parts (1) and (2) are theorems: weave statements for every word, with no bound on the length. The prime above 3 of Census law 5 is a census. Part (3) holds on the surface $M_{1,2}$, whose identification with the weave's object is a reading made within the program, of which only the Euler characteristic is verified ($\chi = 1/12$ by two routes; B1624). The identification of the zero modes with left-handed matter is a further reading and is not used here. The index of the puncture (odd, never zero, and ± 3 once the parity grading is kept, B1606) belongs to Section 6. The triplet is a flavour structure: the record grades the flavour three as derived on the weave and the gauge three as a selection, and the paper claims the first only. The verification of (1)–(3) in the record is B1600 and B1606.

What is classical. A triplet of A_4 on three lines permuted by an order-three element is the standard flavour triplet of discrete flavour models; we cite the use and not the construction [15, 16]. What the weave adds is that the three lines, the group and the irreducibility come from the records' parities and the common point, with no choice of group: proved for every odd-trace word.

Remark 7 (the moves that are not there). The swap of the two records and the inner automorphisms of the free group by a and b are not moves of the grammar adopted here. This matters in Section 4: the group $\langle L, R\rangle \cong B_3$ meets $\mathrm{Inn}(F_2)$ only in $\langle \Delta^4\rangle$, so the weave's group is the braid group, not its extension by the point-pushes. Results of the program that take the inner automorphisms as symmetries hold on branches that add them, and say so (B1634, B1640).

One example. The root's own triplet is the running example of the paper. Its trace 3 is odd, so LR cycles the three parities, its common point is the quaternion point, and its three parity lines form the standard triplet of A_4. It is one of the odd-trace threads of Theorem 6, with no property, for the triplet, that the others lack.

4 The triplet is modular

The question. The triplet of Section 3 is acted on by the moves. The next question is what that action is. If it were an arbitrary finite group, the triplet would carry no further structure. We find instead that the action is the multiplier of a classical family of theta functions: the grammar's moves, with no modular input, reproduce the level-four theta multiplier that modular flavour models use, up to a twist by a power of the eta character. The twist doubles the image from order 48 to order 96 and moves the allowed weights to 3/2 modulo 2 (Theorem efthm:theta). The record is cited by arc [2], and what is known is cited where it is used.

The setting. Take the moves on the ruled branch, that is $\langle L, R\rangle$ with no swap and no sign move beyond those generated (Section 2). This group is the braid group B_3, acting on the once-punctured torus group $F_2 = \langle a, b\rangle$, and it maps onto $\mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$ with kernel $\langle \Delta^4\rangle$, where $\Delta^{-1} = RL^{-1}R$ and $\Delta^2 \mapsto -I$ on homology. The metaplectic group is $\mathrm{Mp}_2(\mathbb{Z}) = \langle s, t \mid s^2 = (st)^3,\ s^8 = 1\rangle = B_3/\langle \Delta^8\rangle$. Write s and t for the images of $RL^{-1}R$ and L in $B_3/\langle \Delta^8\rangle = \mathrm{Mp}_2(\mathbb{Z})$.

Proposition 8 (the inner automorphisms are not moves, B1634)**.** *The group $\langle L, R\rangle \cong B_3$ meets $\mathrm{Inn}(F_2)$ exactly in $\langle \Delta^4\rangle = \langle \mathrm{conj}(c)\rangle$, $c = a\,b^{-1}a^{-1}b$. To word length* 12 *the words acting on F_2 as inner automorphisms are* 1,944 *relators (the identity),* 196 *words for* $\mathrm{conj}(c)$ *and* 196 *for its inverse, and none for* $\mathrm{conj}(a^{\pm 1})$ *or* $\mathrm{conj}(b^{\pm 1})$*. Every word acting on F_2 as an inner automorphism lifts to a scalar on the triplet.*

Proof and scope. The intersection is the classical kernel of $B_3 \to \mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$ acting on π_1 of the punctured torus, and the census to length 12 is exact (B1634, a verification of a claim made within the program). The statement is about the ruled branch only. On branches that add the

sign move or the swap, or give the records' base point moves of its own, the inner automorphisms act, and results that use them are stated there.

The multiplier. Let T be the triplet of Theorem 6, with the lifts of the moves defined on $V = T \oplus \bar{T}$ by the parity-twisted action of Section 3. We write ρ for the representation of the moves on T, $\rho(\gamma) = \mathrm{lift}(\gamma)^{-1}$; this is the convention in which T is cohomology, so its monodromy is the pull-back's inverse. The theta constants are $\theta_2, \theta_3, \theta_4$ in the nome $q = e^{i\pi\tau}$, and $u = (\theta_2^2, \theta_3^2, \theta_4^2)$ satisfies Jacobi's identity $\theta_3^4 = \theta_2^4 + \theta_4^4$. Its components are modular forms of weight one on $\Gamma(4)$, and the graded ring of the modular forms of $\Gamma(4)$ is generated by them modulo that one relation. Both sides have dimension $2d+1$ in weight d: $\Gamma(4)$ has genus zero and six regular cusps [17, ch. 3], and the quotient of the polynomial ring by the irreducible quadric injects because the image has Krull dimension two. Modular flavour models use this ring as their input [1, 18]. The transformation laws of the theta constants, the theta functions with characteristics on the torus, are classical [19, 20]. We write ρ_u for the multiplier of the vector u under $\mathrm{Mp}_2(\mathbb{Z})$; it is trivial on $\Gamma(4)$, and χ_η for the multiplier character of the Dedekind eta function.

Theorem 9 (the theta multiplier, T3)**.** *Take the ruled weave on the triplet T in the convention above.*

1. *The lifts of the moves satisfy the braid relation and send Δ^4 to $-I$. They are therefore a genuine (not projective) representation ρ of $B_3/\langle\Delta^8\rangle = \mathrm{Mp}_2(\mathbb{Z})$.*

2. *ρ equals, with no rescaling, the multiplier of the vector $\eta^{21} \cdot (\theta_2^2, \theta_3^2, \theta_4^2)$:*

$$\rho = \chi_\eta^{21} \otimes \rho_u,$$

   the weight-one multiplier ρ_u of the $\Gamma(4)$ triplet twisted by a power of the eta character. The intertwiner from the parity lines to the theta constants is monomial: θ_3^2 lies on the clock's line (the parity character $(-,-)$), θ_2^2 on the line $(+,-)$, and θ_4^2 on the line $(-,+)$. The exponents of t on T are $(\frac{1}{8}, \frac{3}{8}, \frac{7}{8})$ turns.

3. *The dimension of the space $M_k(\rho)$ of vector-valued forms of weight k for ρ is $0, 0, 1, 1, 2, 2, 3, 3$ at the allowed weights $k = -\frac{1}{2}, \frac{3}{2}, \frac{7}{2}, \ldots, \frac{27}{2}$ (step 2; a weight is* allowed *when the central element acts consistently with it, a necessary condition, not the existence of a form). In particular $\dim M_{3/2}(\rho) = 0$: weight $\frac{3}{2}$ is allowed and carries no form. The dual representation is not allowed at weight $\frac{3}{2}$.*

Proof sketch (record B1634, with B1640's convention scoping). (1) The spin lifts of the moves are elements of the binary octahedral group $2O \subset \mathrm{SU}(2)$ (B1634). Acting on $V = T \oplus \bar{T}$ through the parity twist they generate a finite group of order 96, which acts faithfully on T because T and $\bar{T}$ have the same kernel (B1600). The braid relation holds to the double-precision floor $(3 \cdot 10^{-16})$ and Δ^4, the generator of the kernel, acts as -1 (turns $\frac{1}{8}, \frac{1}{8}, \frac{5}{8}$ for the lift of Δ). The lifts compose in reverse, so $\rho = \mathrm{lift}^{-1}$ is a homomorphism. (2) With s, t as above, $\rho(s)$ and $\rho(t)$ satisfy $s^2 = (st)^3$ and $s^8 = 1$ exactly, so ρ is a representation of $\mathrm{Mp}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. The theta transformation laws, evaluated from the series in τ at several points, fix ρ_u, and a linear solve for an intertwiner with ρ returns an intertwiner with no rescaling (both scale factors equal to 1) and smallest singular value $1.5 \cdot 10^{-15}$; its monomial shape is exact. Four of the eight identifications of (s, t) with the generators and their inverses need no rescaling, and two of them are allowed at weight $3/2$. The record's sealed check of the classical laws failed at one of its two points (the T law off by a relative 1.10 at $\tau = 0.13 + 1.21i$); it was traced to the instrument's principal branch of $q^{1/4}$, and at the other point both laws hold to $2 \cdot 10^{-15}$ (B1634, disclosed there). (3) If $f \in M_k(\rho)$ then $\eta^3 f$ is a form of weight $k + \frac{3}{2}$ for the multiplier of u vanishing at the cusp, and the converse holds; the forms of $\Gamma(4)$ are the polynomials in u modulo the one relation $(2d + 1$

of them in degree d), and the count is exact linear algebra. At $k = \frac{3}{2}$ the only candidate is the Serre derivative of u, whose constant term $-\frac{1}{12}(0,1,1)$ does not vanish, so it gives no form and $\dim M_{3/2}(\rho) = 0$. As a cross-check, the counts above weight 2 agree with the dimension given by the Selberg trace formula [21, §7]. Below weight 2 the same expression is only an Euler characteristic, $\dim M_k(\rho) - \dim S_{2-k}(\rho^\vee)$; at $k = \frac{3}{2}$ it is 0, and both terms vanish. □

Scope. Three limitations are part of the statement.

- *The hand is a convention.* Writing $\rho = \mathrm{lift}^{-1}$ is one of two homomorphisms; the other is the complex conjugate, and the choice of which piece of V is called T is a second binary choice. The two together select ρ or $\bar{\rho}$. The representation is irreducible and not equivalent to its conjugate (an independent exact audit, B1640). The record's choice has weight 3/2 allowed (in the sense above; no form exists there) and admits the lowest symmetric weight-one coupling (B1640); the conjugate has neither. So the index and that coupling come with the same hand, and which hand the matter carries is not derived here. The hand's functorial reason (cohomology pulls back) is a reading of the record, not a theorem of this section.

- *The eta twist.* The theorem identifies ρ with the theta multiplier up to the one-dimensional character χ_η^{21}; it is not the bare weight-one multiplier of $\Gamma(4)$'s triplet. The restriction of ρ to $\Gamma(4)$ is that character. We do not claim that the twist is forced rather than a convention of the homology generators.

- *The dimension formula.* The identification of the forms of $\Gamma(4)$ with the polynomials in u modulo Jacobi's identity holds in every degree d by the argument in the setting above (injectivity, and dimension $2d+1$ on both sides). It rests on the standard dimension formula $2d+1$ for the genus-zero curve with six regular cusps; it was also certified numerically for $d \leq 5$.

Remark 10 (the modulus breaks the weave's group). On the ruled branch the weave forces no point of the upper half-plane. At a generic τ the stabilizer of τ in $\langle L, R\rangle$ is the centre, so the residual symmetry on T is four scalars. At $\tau = i$ it is cyclic of order 8, a plane containing the clock's line and a line in the span of the letters' two lines; at $\tau = \omega = e^{2\pi i/3}$ it is cyclic of order 12, with three eigenlines, each with squared overlap $\frac{1}{3}$ with every parity line (B1634). Consequently the modulus τ is the state that breaks the weave's group. On the modular-flavour ansatz (holomorphic couplings, a minimal Kähler term, one copy of T per field, one Higgs per sector), which this paper uses only for the ruled-branch bound of Theorem 27, the flavour numbers would be the values of vector-valued modular forms for ρ at τ. The couplings of Section 5 are built from such forms together with norms that are not holomorphic, so they are not of that kind. The statements of the earlier record that used the inner automorphisms as symmetries (an order-48 residual at ω, a permutation mixing for every τ) hold on the branches where those act and not on the ruled branch.

Position against the literature. We state which parts are known and which are the paper's.

- *Known.* Modular flavour symmetry, in which fermion mass matrices are modular forms and the flavour group is a finite quotient of the modular group acting on a multiplet [22]. The weight-one level-four forms from two theta constants, and the triplet of S_4' they form, as the inputs of flavour models [1, 18]. Residual symmetries at the fixed points of the modular group and the hierarchies that follow from the neighbourhood of a fixed point [23]. Zero modes of magnetized tori as multiplets of a modular group, and Yukawa couplings from their overlaps [24, 25]. The theta constants as the three even theta characteristics of the torus [20].

- *The paper's.* Not the triplet, nor the modular group, nor the theta constants. The paper's content is the chain: the records' own parities and the common point give the triplet (Theorem 6), the grammar's moves act on it as a genuine $\mathrm{Mp}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ representation (Theorem 9), and that representation is the theta multiplier up to a monomial intertwiner and an eta character. Modular flavour models choose the untwisted symmetry; here the symmetry of the moves is that one up to the eta twist and the hand, as scoped above.

The theorem does not say that the program's weave is any of those models, and it does not select a modulus, a weight or a vacuum. The reading of the zero modes as the overlap integrals of the magnetized-torus literature is an open lead of the record, not a result of this section.

Reading. Three objects permuted by an order-three element, with a metaplectic group acting on them, appear on both sides: the records' parities and the theta constants. We read the triplet as modular because the records are: the symmetry is the one the moves carry, and a flavour model that chooses it is choosing, up to the stated twist and hand, what the grammar already does. What this reading cannot supply is the modulus. A symmetry that the moves carry is broken by the state, and which state is a selection (Section 8).

5 The couplings on the fibre

The question. Section 4 gave the grammar a triplet whose symmetry is a classical modular multiplier. A triplet becomes physics only when something couples it. We therefore ask what the triplet allows as a coupling, which couplings the moves allow, and how much of the coupling's shape is fixed before any value is chosen. The answers are exact statements about one fibre and one modulus τ. They are not statements about the Standard Model, and each carries the frame in which it holds. The record is cited by its arcs (B1644 to B1666) and by the repository [2].

Setting and frame. Let E_τ be the fibre torus with its puncture, carrying the local system of Section 3. By the triplet postulate (Table 1) the three holomorphic zero modes, one per parity, are the triplet. Their pairing at the puncture defines a vector $\rho(\tau) = (\rho_i, \rho_j, \rho_k)$,

$$\rho_i = -\frac{\theta_2^2}{2\pi\eta^3}, \qquad \rho_j = -\frac{\theta_4^2}{2\pi\eta^3}, \qquad \rho_k = \frac{i\,\theta_3^2}{2\pi\eta^3},$$

the *theta triplet*, with the arguments τ and the zero argument understood. (The record writes R for this vector; we write ρ because R is a move. It is a vector, not the representation ρ of Section 4.) The Higgs lives in the space $\mathcal{M}$ of the fibre's quaternion structure, the traceless complex 2×2 matrices, spanned by its three imaginary units, with the quadratic form $a \cdot a$. Two facts are used throughout.

Lemma 11 (Jacobi)**.** $\rho \cdot \rho = 0$ *for every* τ*.*

Proof. By the entries above, $\rho \cdot \rho = (\theta_2^4 + \theta_4^4 - \theta_3^4)/(2\pi\eta^3)^2$, which vanishes by Jacobi's identity $\theta_3^4 = \theta_2^4 + \theta_4^4$ [19]. The same identity gives $v \cdot v = 0$ for the pairing triplet $v(z) = c_r\theta_r(0)\theta_r(z)/\theta_1(z)$ at every point z of the fibre, through $\theta_4(z)^2\theta_4^2 + \theta_2(z)^2\theta_2^2 = \theta_3(z)^2\theta_3^2$. □

What the grammar supplies here. The grammar supplies the triplet and its multiplier (Theorem 9). The isotropy of the theta triplet is Jacobi's identity, a classical fact. The fibre frame and the triplet postulate supply the coupling. The results of this section are what the fibre frame fixes, given the postulate.

Frame dependence, stated first. The results of §5.1 hold in the *fibre frame*: the Higgs is a section on the fibre itself, the zero modes are the triplet, and the triplet postulate holds at one τ. They fail, or change meaning, in the two other frames on record. In the surface frame, a reading made within the program, the massless generation is not present. In the E_8 frame studied within the program the Higgs in $\mathcal{M}$ is a Standard Model singlet, a flavon, and a physical Yukawa coupling needs two condensates, a doublet–singlet pairing, or the parent map. B1644's and B1649's verdicts carry this scope (B1648, B1655); the frame tribunal (B1652, Section 7) finds no frame shown to meet all of the principle's demands alone. Everything in this section is therefore a statement about the fibre frame and says so.

5.1 Isotropy and the massless generation

For a direction $a \in \mathcal{M}$, the Higgs in $\mathcal{M}$ couples the zero modes at the puncture by the symmetric 3×3 matrix

$$Y(a) = a\,\rho^T + \rho\,a^T - (a \cdot \rho)\,\text{⊮}.$$

Theorem 12 (Isotropy and the massless generation; T4)**.** *Given the triplet postulate at one τ, in the fibre frame, with zero Wilson line, the Higgs at the puncture (the parent map owed), the record's hand, the lifts' agreement with the ruled moves checked at Δ^4 alone, and $M_{1,2}$ as the weave's surface:*

1. *(B1644)* $\det Y(a) = (\rho \cdot \rho)(a \cdot a)(\rho \cdot a) = 0$ *for every direction a and every τ. Indeed $Y(a)\rho = 0 = Y(a)^T\rho$: one generation is massless, and the massless state is the theta triplet.*

2. *(B1645) For real a the two other singular values have ratio $m \in [\frac{1}{2}, 1]$, set by one angle: with $\kappa = 2|a \cdot \rho|^2/(|\rho|^2|a|^2) \in [0,1]$ (for real a and isotropic ρ, $|a \cdot \rho|^2 \le \frac{1}{2}|\rho|^2|a|^2$), $m^2 = \xi_-/\xi_+$ where $\xi^2 - (4+\kappa)\xi + 4 = 0$. The value is $\frac{1}{2}$ for a in the plane of ρ and 1 for a normal to it. $Y(a)$ has rank one exactly on the isotropic cone $a \cdot a = 0$, and near the cone m grows as $|a \cdot a|/|a|^2$.*

3. *(B1646) In the unitary frame $(\rho/|\rho|, \bar{\rho}/|\rho|, n)$ fixed by τ, $Y(a)$ vanishes on ρ and maps* $\text{span}(\bar{\rho}, n)$ *to* $\text{span}(\rho, n)$ *by $M_2(a) = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 2(a\cdot\bar{\rho}) & |\rho|(a\cdot n) \\ |\rho|(a\cdot n) & -(a\cdot\rho) \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, with $\det M_2 = -|\rho|^2(a \cdot a)$. The map $a \mapsto M_2(a)$ is a linear bijection onto the complex symmetric 2×2 matrices: the direction* is *the mass matrix of the two massive generations.*

4. *(B1649) For every Higgs $S \in \text{End}(\mathbb{C}^2)$ at the puncture, ρ is a two-sided null vector of the zero modes' residue coupling $Y(S)$, which is linear in S ($S = $ ⊮ gives the antisymmetric cross product $[\rho]_\times$, and $S \in \mathcal{M}$ gives the formula above). With both quark sectors on one fibre the left massless states coincide, so the mixing matrix is $V = 1 \oplus U(2)$ and $m_u = m_d = \theta_{12} = \theta_{13} = J = 0$ at leading order.*

Proof sketch. (1) is the determinant of a rank-two perturbation of a scalar, $Y(a)\rho = a(\rho \cdot \rho) + \rho(a \cdot \rho) - (a \cdot \rho)\rho$, which vanishes by Lemma 11; B1644 also checks the symbolic determinant. (2) follows from $s_1 s_2 = |\rho|^2|a|^2$ and $s_1^2 + s_2^2 = 2|\rho|^2|a|^2 + |a \cdot \rho|^2$ for real a. (3) is a direct computation in the frame. (4) uses linearity in S and Lemma 11 at the puncture; B1649 evaluates the residues by contour integrals to $5 \cdot 10^{-31}$. See B1644, B1645, B1646, B1649. □

Scope. The identities are exact. The bound $m \ge \frac{1}{2}$ is exact for real directions (B1645) and does not hold for complex ones, where m falls to 0.004 in B1644's numerics. The quartic-potential statement of B1646, that minima of a potential symmetric under $SO(3)$ and a phase lie on the cone or on the real locus and never between, is for that quartic; an octic invariant or the zero modes' one-loop term puts minima between (B1655). The statement about $V = 1 \oplus U(2)$ is leading order and fibre-frame only. That the τ of the fibre is a physical modulus is not claimed.

Proposition 13 (ρ is the residue of the one nilpotent Higgs; B1650)**.** *On the fibre, let $\hat{f}_r$ be the function with residue one at the puncture and $\hat{f}_r^{\,2} = \wp(z) - \wp(z_r)$, with each unit e_r at the half-period z_r where its theta function vanishes ($i \leftrightarrow \frac{1}{2}$, $j \leftrightarrow \tau/2$, $k \leftrightarrow (1+\tau)/2$). The field $\Phi_\rho = \sum_r \rho_r \hat{f}_r\, \mathsf{e}_r\, dz$ has*

$$\Phi_\rho^2 = -\Big[(\rho\cdot\rho)\,\wp(z) - \sum_r \rho_r^2\,\wp(z_r)\Big]dz^2 = 0,$$

the second term vanishing identically in the theta constants. So it is a Higgs field nilpotent at every point, and its residue is ρ. Of the six assignments of the units to the half-periods, this is, up to the Klein group's signs, the only one with this property at a generic τ.

Status. Verified in B1650 in independent code: $\wp$ is computed through $-(\log\theta_1)''$, whose additive constant drops out of $\sum_r \rho_r^2\wp(z_r)$ because $\rho\cdot\rho = 0$, and the residual is $2.6\cdot10^{-32}$ to $1.7\cdot10^{-31}$ at four values of τ. The five other pairings of units to half-periods give 0.46 to 4.96, except one that also vanishes at $\tau = i$ where $\theta_2 = \theta_4$. The step that a genuine cusp forces a nilpotent residue ($a\cdot a = 0$) rests on the tame Higgs correspondence and was not re-derived in the record (B1650 section 3) [26]. The proposition does not use it.

5.2 Which couplings the moves allow

Theorem 14 (Covariance; T5)**.** *In the fibre frame, with covariance under the moves invoked where τ varies (the surface frame, B1651), the move $L : \tau \mapsto \tau+1$ acts on the pairing triplet as $\mathrm{Ad}(g_L)^{-1}$ and $R : \tau \mapsto \tau/(\tau+1)$ as $\mathrm{Ad}(g_R)$, with no Klein element, at the puncture and at every half-period (in the lifts of Theorem 6 this is the lift twisted by the Klein element i on L, which accounts for the inverse). The half-periods' triplets $(0,-1,i)$, $(i,0,1)$, $(i,-1,0)$ do not depend on τ. The lifts of the moves act on the Higgs space $\mathcal{M}$ through the octahedral group O (order 24), irreducibly. Hence no constant direction $a \in \mathcal{M}$ is covariant; modulo the Klein group the twisted moves share exactly the four real body diagonals, so the only covariant class is the real democratic one.*

Proof sketch. The covariance identities hold exactly (to $2\cdot10^{-16}$), and a swapped-matrix control fails. Irreducibility of O on the three-dimensional representation, and the common eigenlines of the twisted lifts, are finite group theory. See B1651. □

Scope. B1655 scopes the corollary B1651 draws, that the Higgs's locus is not forced to the puncture: it holds for a *point or density Higgs*, a premise that no cell of the arc tests. A Higgs carrying a parity, in the triplet, couples at the puncture (B1651's addendum). So in the surface frame the covariant loci for an even single-point Higgs are the puncture, the half-period orbit, or both; in the fibre frame at one τ any of them is kept (B1651). The conclusion for other Higgs types is not made.

5.3 The field stage

The next five statements are propositions: each is exact in its frame, none is a value, and each is stated with its inputs. They are the steps between a point coupling and a mass matrix.

Proposition 15 (The rank of a point coupling; B1653)**.** *At the puncture both components of the zero modes behave like $\zeta^{-1/2}$, with ζ a local coordinate at the puncture,, so the residue of a product is a rank-one bilinear $v_x v_y^T$ of one doublet. Hence for every flat line and every Higgs the record's coupling has rank at most 2, and the massless left state is the left field's alone; the four unit residues form a null quaternion ($r_1^2 + r\cdot r = 0$, with r_1 the identity unit's residue and r the line-twisted triplet of the other three, equal to ρ at $w = 0$; on a flat line $r\cdot r \neq 0$ in general), so up and down share the left null vector and $V = 1 \oplus U(2)$ at a point, for every line. What lifts the zero must not act as a point: two points, a tilted or anisotropic profile, or a profile about the puncture. A radially symmetric profile about a regular point acts as the point.*

Scope. Exact (rank ≤ 2 at every line on the record to $7 \cdot 10^{-41}$; two-point and profile controls lift).

Proposition 16 (The norm of the boundary class; B1654)**.** *The parity Higgs's only massless mode is the boundary class at the puncture. Its norm needs an end cutoff: for the Szegő kernels of the even spin structures,* $\|S_r\|_\epsilon^2 = 2\pi \log(1/\epsilon) + c_r(\tau)$*, where* ϵ *is the radius of a disc removed at the puncture. The* end radius $\mathcal{E}$ *enters as* $\mathcal{E} = \log(1/\epsilon)$ *(the logarithm of a regulator), and the regularised norm is* $2\pi\mathcal{E} + c_r$*. Under equal canonical amplitudes the cutoff's logarithm cancels by Lemma 11: with* $\hat{\rho}_r = \sqrt{2\pi\mathcal{E} + c_r}\,\rho_r$*,* $\hat{\rho} \cdot \hat{\rho} = 2\pi\mathcal{E}(\rho \cdot \rho) + D = D$*, where*

$$D(\tau) = \sum_r c_r(\tau)\rho_r^2 = \int_P \sum_r \rho_r^2 |S_r|^2 \, dA$$

is finite and canonical. The first generation's lift is $D/(2\pi\mathcal{E})$*.* D *is zero at* $\tau = \omega$ *(the order-3 move equalises the norms),* $|D|/|\rho|^2$ *is modular invariant, and toward the cusp along* $\tau = iy$*,* $D/(q|\rho|^2) = 8\pi^2 y + 8\pi(1 - 4\ln 2)$ *up to a relative correction that is exponentially small in* y*, with* $q = e^{i\pi\tau}$*. For* $\tau = x + iy$ *the leading term is* $e^{-i\pi x/2}\left[8\pi^2 y + 4\pi(1 + e^{-2\pi i x}) - 32\pi \ln 2\right]$*, which is the displayed one at* $x = 0$*; the paper's check* `checks/cusp_law.py` *confirms it at* $x = 0, \frac{3}{10}, \frac{1}{2}, 1$ *and* $y = 4, 5$*. Under equal framed data there is no lift.*

Scope. Exact to $1.2 \cdot 10^{-10}$ by two routes; the direct D to $1.6 \cdot 10^{-14}$. B1655 scopes it to its premises (the canonical end condition among them) and finds the lift sensitive to the channels' amplitudes: at $\tau = i$, $\mathcal{E} = 40$, a 1% error in one channel's amplitude changes it by a factor 2.2. Which end condition is physical is open. In the flat metric none fixes $\mathcal{E}$; the fibre's hyperbolic metric fixes it at order one (Census law 25). The lift is diagonal along ρ, so the light state's angle goes as $1/\mathcal{E}$.

Proposition 17 (The electron's zero; B1656)**.** *On the stated inputs, namely the eighteen flat lines* $w = p_1\tau - p_2$ *of exact order nine at* $\tau = \omega$*, for which* $3w$ *is fixed by the order-three move, the hypercharge dictionary (Table 1, with* $6Y$ *the minimal integral normalisation), and B1654's canonical end condition, the charged leptons' first generation stays exactly massless for every Higgs and every channel weight, while the quarks are lifted.*

Proof sketch. A flat hypercharge line twists each sector's residue triplet. At ω the three perpendicular channels have equal norms, so $D_{\text{sector}} = (c_1 - c_\perp) r_1^2$, with one gap -5.806896. Since $q_L - q_e = -9 = -3q_H$ and these lines have $3w$ fixed by the order-3 move, $9w$ lies in the lattice and $r_1(\text{leptons}) = \theta_1(-9w) = 0$. The quarks' $|D|/\|r\|^2$, with r the sector's residue, take 1.0312, 2.4629, 2.7416 in a 3-cycle over the lines' classes. See B1656.
Scope. Given $\tau = \omega$ and these lines, both stated, and the dictionary. Controls off ω, off the fixed lines, with other charges, and with r_1 alone at equal norms all lift. The identification of the dictionary is an input, not a result, and the minimal normalisation is a choice.

Proposition 18 (The symmetric point; B1657)**.** *At* $\tau = \omega$*, in the untwisted frame, the Higgs's symmetric vacua are the axes* $\rho, \bar{\rho}, n$ *of B1646's frame. In* ρ*'s basis the order-3 move is the real signed permutation* P *(*$P^T P = \mathbb{1}$*,* $P^3 = -\mathbb{1}$*) with eigenlines* ρ *(*$e^{-i\pi/3}$*),* $\bar{\rho}$ *(*$e^{i\pi/3}$*) and* n *(*-1*). A Higgs on* n *gives masses* $(1, 1, 0)$*; on* ρ *or* $\bar{\rho}$ *the coupling has rank one. Near the isotropic vacua the light masses obey two laws, with* $d_x = x \cdot x/|x|^2$*: for the conjugate vacuum (*$a \approx \bar{\rho}$*,* $v \approx \rho$*) the light masses over the heavy are* $|d_a|$ *and* $|d_v|$*; for the parallel vacuum (*$a \approx \rho$*,* $v \approx \rho$*) they are* $|d_a + d_v|/4$ *and* $|d_a d_v|/4$*, a geometric hierarchy. Under B1654's canonical end condition with the Higgs on the line, one generation stays massless and* $\mathcal{E}\, s_2/s_1 \to |D|/(2\pi|\rho|^2)$ *or* $|D|/(8\pi|\rho|^2)$*;* $D(\gamma\tau)(c\tau + d) = -D(\tau)$ *for the order-3 move makes* D *a cone at* ω*.*

Scope. Untwisted, one fibre, one τ; no cell is blind (B1657). It is a statement about symmetric points of this frame; it is not a selection of ω (Section 8).

Proposition 19 (The twisted half bound; B1658)**.** *In the twisted frame of B1656, under equal framed data, one Higgs keeps the sectors' second generations within a factor* 4*, exactly. For a null matter residue* $M = pq^T$ *and any complex Higgs* S*,* $\operatorname{adj} Y(S, M) = \det S\, A$ *with* $A = \tilde{q}\tilde{p}^T = A(M)$ *(Theorem 20) and* $\|A\| = 2\|M\|^2$*, and each sector's spectrum is* $(1, t, 0)$ *with* $t + 1/t = \|Y\|^2/(2|\det S|\|M\|^2)$*. The Gram spectrum of* $S \mapsto Y(S, M)$ *is* $\{1, 2, 2, 4\}\|M\|^2$*, so* $\|Y\|^2 \in [1, 4]\|S\|^2\|M\|^2$*. One Higgs shares* $\det S$*, so the sectors'* $t + 1/t$ *lie within a factor* 4 *of each other.*

Scope. The bound is exact. Its comparison with the measured running masses [27] at M_Z is a scoreboard (the data were seen): the ratio for the up quarks against the leptons needs 15.9, so one Higgs is refuted *under equal framed data*. Under the canonical end condition the question is B1660's census (Section 7), with the same answer for one Higgs.

5.4 The joint law

Proposition 19 is the restriction to the null cone of an exact factorisation. In B1656's twisted frame the Higgs is $S \in M_2(\mathbb{C})$ and a sector's matter residue is $M = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} m_0 & m_1 \\ m_2 & m_3 \end{smallmatrix}\right) \in M_2(\mathbb{C})$. With $\epsilon = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ and the three quaternion units $(C_1, C_2, C_3) = (\epsilon,\ \operatorname{diag}(i, -i),\ \operatorname{diag}(i, -i)\,\epsilon)$, the coupling is the bilinear 3×3 matrix

$$Y(S, M)_{ab} = \sum_{m,n} \big(C_a^T \epsilon\, S\, C_b\big)_{mn} M_{mn}.$$

Call $\det S$ and $\det M$ the *defects* of the Higgs and the matter, and $\operatorname{tr}(\epsilon S M^T)$ their *pairing*.

Theorem 20 (The joint law; T7)**.** *For every* $S, M \in M_2(\mathbb{C})$*,*

$$\det Y(S, M) = 4 \det S\, \det M\, \operatorname{tr}(\epsilon S M^T), \qquad \operatorname{adj} Y(S, M) = \det S\, A(M) + \det M\, P\, A(S),$$

where $P = \operatorname{diag}(1, -1, -1)$ *and* $A(M)$ *is the quadratic*

$$A(M) = \begin{pmatrix} m_0^2 + m_1^2 + m_2^2 + m_3^2 & 2i(m_0 m_2 + m_1 m_3) & -i(m_0^2 + m_1^2 - m_2^2 - m_3^2) \\ 2i(m_0 m_1 + m_2 m_3) & -4 m_1 m_2 & 2(m_0 m_1 - m_2 m_3) \\ -i(m_0^2 - m_1^2 + m_2^2 - m_3^2) & 2(m_0 m_2 - m_1 m_3) & -m_0^2 + m_1^2 + m_2^2 - m_3^2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

With $N = M\epsilon$ *the coupling is symmetric in the Higgs and the matter,* $Y(S, N\epsilon^{-1}) = Y(N, S\epsilon^{-1})$*, and* $\det Y = -4 \det S \det N \operatorname{polar}(S, N)$*, where* polar *is the polar form of* det*. Consequently:*

1. $m_1 = 0$ *if and only if the Higgs is null (*$\det S = 0$*), the matter is null (*$\det M = 0$*), or the pairing vanishes.*
2. *The squared masses are the roots of* $x^3 - e_1 x^2 + e_2 x - e_3$ *with* $e_1 = \|Y\|^2$*,* $e_2 = \|\det S\, A(M) + \det M\, PA(S)\|^2$ *and* $e_3 = 16|\det S \det M \operatorname{tr}(\epsilon S M^T)|^2$*. In the hierarchical limit the middle mass reads the sum of the two defects' terms, with interference, and the lightest is their product times the pairing over the other two masses; both light masses are first order in the defects.*
3. *At the coincident point* $N = S$ *the masses are exactly geometric,* $m_1 m_3 = m_2^2$*.*

Proof sketch. Both laws are polynomial identities in the eight entries of S and M. B1659 checks them symbolically (residual 0) and, for the sector matter of B1656, at 324 random draws. The symmetric form and the pairing's polar identity $\operatorname{tr}(\epsilon S M^T) = -\big(\det(S + N) - \det S - \det N\big)$ are symbolic too. On the null cone $M = pq^T$ the first term of $\operatorname{adj} Y$ is B1658's $\det S\, \tilde{q}\tilde{p}^T$ with the tilde, not the transpose. Item 1 is the vanishing of e_3. Item 3 is the singular-value identity at $N = S$ (to $4 \cdot 10^{-14}$). The controls fail as expected: the constant 3 for 4, A for PA, and $N \neq S$ each break the corresponding identity. See B1659. □

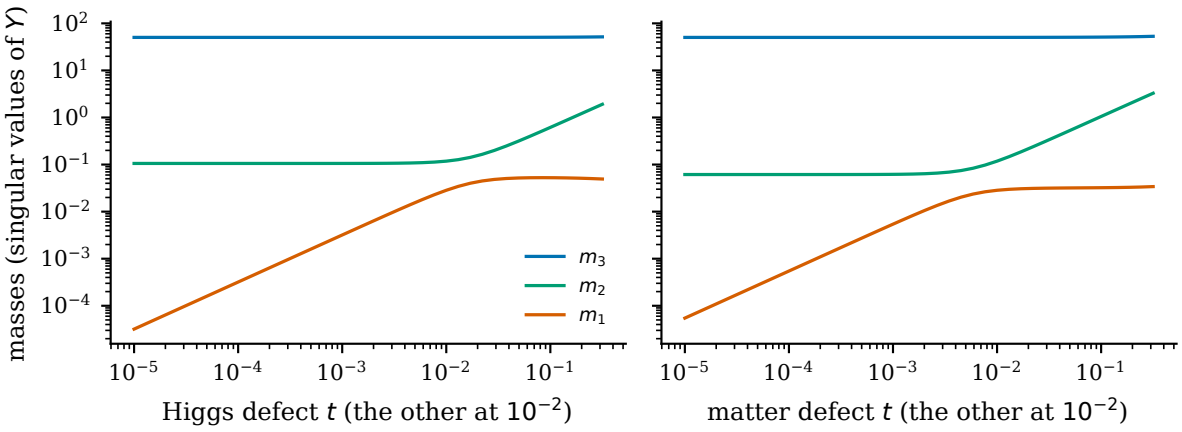


Figure 3: The joint law (Theorem 20): two defects and three masses, an illustrative recomputation from the theorem's formulas (not an arc's output). In the twisted frame, with a null Higgs and a null matter perturbed by defects of scale t (left: the Higgs; right: the matter; the other side's defect fixed at 10^{-2}), the heaviest mass stays, the middle mass reads the larger defect's term, and the lightest, bilinear in the two defects, falls linearly in the varied one until it meets the other. Exact identities over $M_2(\mathbb{C}) \times M_2(\mathbb{C})$ at one τ; no data.

Scope. Exact over $M_2(\mathbb{C}) \times M_2(\mathbb{C})$, for every Higgs and every matter, in B1656's twisted frame. It uses no data. It does not say which Higgs or which matter occurs, nor the size of the first generation against nature, and it is one τ and a frozen piece of the weave: the interacting weave is not treated. The relation of this frame to the untwisted frame of Proposition 18 is not claimed to be a linear equivalence.

Reading. The coupling's shape is two defects and a pairing. Each defect measures how far a field sits from the null cone; a massless generation is a field, or a pairing, that has sat exactly on it. What the grammar fixes is this shape. Where the fields sit is the choice of a world.

5.5 The period phase: the bridge to the motion

The couplings so far hold at one point of the modular surface. The threads of Section 3 are closed paths through it, and the matter's defect D of Proposition 16 is a function along each. How D transforms under the moves decides how an amplitude built from it can be averaged over a thread.

Lemma 21 (Automorphy of the defect)**.** *The defect D has weight -1 and the multiplier χ of η^6: for $g = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ in the modular group, $D(g\tau) = \chi(g)(c\tau + d)^{-1}D(\tau)$, with $\chi(\tau \mapsto \tau + 1) = \chi(\tau \mapsto -1/\tau) = i$. Hence $\chi(L) = i$ and $\chi(R) = -i$ for the two letters of the grammar.*

Proof. Write $D = -\theta_3^4 h(\lambda)/(4\pi\eta^6)$ with $\lambda = \theta_2^4/\theta_3^4$ and $h(\lambda) = \lambda \log|\lambda| + (1-\lambda)\log|1-\lambda|$ (the closed form checked in B1657). Under $\tau \mapsto \tau + 1$, $\theta_3 \leftrightarrow \theta_4$ and $\theta_2 \mapsto e^{i\pi/4}\theta_2$, so $\lambda \mapsto \lambda/(\lambda - 1)$ and $\theta_3^4 \mapsto \theta_4^4 = \theta_3^4(1-\lambda)$; a short computation gives $h(\lambda/(\lambda-1)) = -h(\lambda)/(1-\lambda)$, and $\eta^6 \mapsto i\eta^6$. Hence $D(\tau+1) = iD(\tau)$. Under $\tau \mapsto -1/\tau$, $\theta_3 \mapsto \sqrt{-i\tau}\,\theta_3$ and $\theta_2 \leftrightarrow \theta_4$ with the same factor, so $\lambda \mapsto 1-\lambda$, $\theta_3^4 \mapsto -\tau^2\theta_3^4$, $h(1-\lambda) = h(\lambda)$, and $\eta^6 \mapsto (-i\tau)^3\eta^6 = i\tau^3\eta^6$. Hence $D(-1/\tau) = i\,\tau^{-1}D(\tau)$. Both sides of the law compose by the cocycle rule, and the two maps generate the modular group, so the law holds on the group. The letters follow from $L : \tau \mapsto \tau+1$ and $R = S_0 L^{-1} S_0^{-1}$ (Appendix A). □

Remark. D is real-analytic, not holomorphic, because of $\log|\cdot|$; the law is nonetheless exact. The record also checks it numerically at L, R, S_0 and $L^{-1}R$, to 10^{-30}.

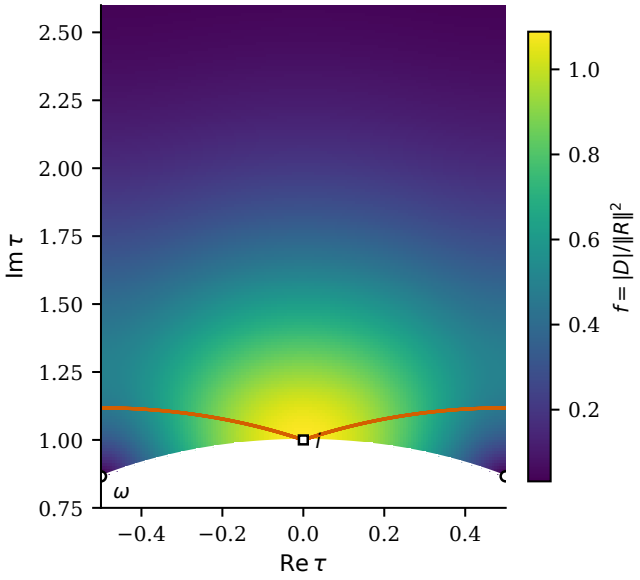


Figure 4: The matter's defect relative to its norm, $f = |D|/\|\rho\|^2$, on the fundamental domain. It is modular-invariant (Lemma 21), vanishes at ω and toward the cusp, and peaks near i. The root LR's closed geodesic, reduced to the domain, passes through i. Computed with the sealed instrument's f (B1663).

Theorem 22 (The period phase)**.** *Along a thread, let $z(s)$ be the geodesic in the upper half-plane, with s its arclength, and let $\psi(s) = D(z(s))\,(dz/ds)^{-1/2}$ be the* amplitude*. Then after one period the amplitude returns multiplied by*

$$\psi(s+\ell) = i^{\#L-\#R}\,\psi(s),$$

the exponent counting the letters of the thread's word γ. Consequently a coherent average of ψ over a thread survives only if $\#L \equiv \#R \pmod 4$.

Proof sketch. Along a closed geodesic the period is the hyperbolic element $\gamma = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ of the thread's word, with $z(s+\ell) = \gamma z(s)$. The derivative dz/ds transforms by $(cz+d)^{-2}$ and D by $\chi(\gamma)(cz+d)^{-1}$ (Lemma 21). Let $r(s)$ be the ratio of the continuation of $(dz/ds)^{-1/2}$ from s to $s+\ell$ to its value at s. Then $r^2 = (cz+d)^2$. Since $cz+d$ has no zero on $\mathbb{H}$ and r is continuous, $r = \epsilon\,(cz+d)$ with one sign ϵ for all s. As $s \to -\infty$, both $z(s)$ and $z(s+\ell)$ tend to the repelling fixed point x of γ and the two tangent directions agree, so r tends to a positive number (a power of the ratio of the two heights), while $cz+d \to cx+d$. This is an eigenvalue of γ, positive because a word in L and R has positive trace. Hence $\epsilon = +1$, $\psi(s+\ell) = \chi(\gamma)\psi(s)$, and $\chi(\gamma) = \chi(L)^{\#L}\chi(R)^{\#R} = i^{\#L-\#R}$ because χ is a character. Census law 23 (B1666) checks this numerically. □

Scope. Exact for every thread, by Lemma 21 and the argument above. It concerns D alone, not the physical amplitude, which also needs the Higgs's own transformation (the determinant and the pairing) that B1656's frame leaves free.

Census law 23 (Period phase over the threads; B1666)**.** On all 30 674 threads with trace at most 600 the least-squares phase over two consecutive periods, $\sum g(s+\ell)\overline{g(s)} / \sum |g|^2$, equals $i^{\#L-\#R}$ with error at most $1.1 \cdot 10^{-7}$. The phase is 1 on 0.2508 of the threads, as the four values of the character predict. The ratio includes the square root's branch, so the census checks numerically the branch sign $+1$ that Theorem 22 proves for every thread.

Scope. A census to trace 600; no statement for longer threads. It is a sealed test (preregistered, run once), and the earlier gates that failed at the zeros of D (B1664, B1665) are disclosed in Section 9.

What the bridge shows. Two companion readings from the same sealed arc, both scoreboards (the data of B1664 and B1665 were seen, so they are not blind), are developed in Section 7. Averaged trace by trace, the threads' average of the defect $f = |D|/\|\rho\|^2$ approaches the constant mode of the modular surface, 0.31500491, as the equidistribution of closed geodesics predicts [28, 29]; and the amplitude, unlike the size, has no constant wave: its coherence falls with length. The first is expected, the second is the content. Neither fixes a value of the Standard Model.

6 A chiral index ± 3, given its inputs

The question. The couplings of Section 5 treat the triplet as a representation. A generation, in the physical sense, is a *count* of chiral fermions, which is an index. We ask when the grammar's triplet becomes such a count and what must be assumed. The answer is conditional on stated inputs, and it is not an index of a thread. On any cusped three-manifold or cover every twisted Euler characteristic vanishes (B1604; Boundary result 26), so no flat-module count on a single thread is an Euler-type index. Other physical operators, with boundary or family data, would need their own analysis. The count lives on the fibre family, as follows. The record is cited by arc [2].

The setting. The weave's surface is $M_{1,2}$, the moduli of a torus with two marked points, taken as the weave's surface by a reading made within the program, of which the record verifies only the Euler characteristic (B1624). Its fibre loops, the point-pushes, are the inner automorphisms, and the weave's moves lift to the matter by the lift that agrees with the ruled moves (B1641). That lift is the record's: conj(a) and conj(b) act on the triplet by the parity signs and the commutator loop by -1, which is Δ^4 of the moves. The geometric lift, trivial on cohomology, differs from it by that central sign at Δ^4.

Three ends. Three different things are called an end here. The fibre's puncture is the marked point of one torus, and Λ_+ is a boundary condition there. The modular cusp is an end of the base of the family, and the integer n is its datum. The radius L below is a cutoff near the puncture in a fixed fibre. The record gives no law that identifies these three, and none is assumed.

The inputs.

- **The triplet postulate** (Table 1): the left-handed matter lives in the triplet T and the mass tensor couples it. A tagged working postulate, in the record the subspace named Λ (renamed here to avoid the cosmological constant). What would discharge it: a derivation of which fields carry T (the dictionary), or an obstruction. An index for the count does not pay it.
- **One cusp unit**: the cusp contributes n units of the end datum, with $n = \pm 1$ when one unit is taken. A tagged working postulate. What would discharge it: an end mechanism at the cusp.
- **The extreme boundary domain**: the subspace Λ_+ of the critical coefficients at the fibre's puncture is taken to be 0 or the whole module L_6. Other move-invariant domains give ± 1 (below). What would discharge it: a rule that selects the domain.

The setting, $M_{1,2}$ as the weave's surface with the lift that agrees with the ruled moves, is a reading verified only in part, and we list it with the inputs. None is derived in the record: the first is a postulate, the second a normalisation at an end the grammar does not fix, the third a choice of domain. All are priced in the inputs table (Table 1). The "3" is the dimension of the postulated triplet, read through the extreme domain; it is not a derived count of generations.

Theorem 24 (The index ±3; T6)**.** *Given the triplet postulate and n units at the cusp, on $M_{1,2}$ with the weave's lifts, the four-dimensional index is $n(|\Lambda_+| - 3)$, where $|\Lambda_+|$ is the dimension of the chosen subspace Λ_+ of the critical coefficients at the fibre's puncture. For $\Lambda_+ = 0$ the index is $+3, 0, -3$ for $n = -1, 0, 1$; for the two-dimensional piece V_2 of the six-dimensional module it is $+1, 0, -1$ and for V_4 it is $-1, 0, +1$; and for the full module L_6 it is $-3, 0, +3$. With one cusp unit, $n = \pm 1$, a non-zero (chiral) index is therefore ± 3 for $\Lambda_+ = 0$ or $\Lambda_+ = L_6$.*

Proof sketch. The six-dimensional module L_6 is a representation of the metaplectic cover $\mathrm{Mp}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ with exponents $(1, 1, 3, 5, 7, 7)/8$ and commutant of dimension 2 (braid relation exact). It splits as $V_2 \oplus V_4$, two non-isomorphic irreducibles, so no three-dimensional constituent exists. The characters χ_1 of the pieces and of L_6 vanish and $\chi_{3/2}(\rho_T) = 0 = \chi_{1/2}(\bar{\rho}_T)$, so weight one is allowed, and the index formula $\dim \Lambda_+ - 3$, a Riemann–Roch computation taken as stated in B1606 and not re-derived there, with the dimension formula for vector-valued modular forms (as used in B1632), gives the fibre's contribution; the index is n times it. The table is verified in both identifications of the module. See B1641. The equality is the record's modular count for the fibre family. It does not execute a four-dimensional Dirac operator, and the exact sequence behind the dimension formula is not shown as a sequence of the bare representations (B1641). □

Scope. Verified for the module and the lifts named; the setting, $M_{1,2}$ as the weave's surface, is a reading, and whether the lifts cohere over the whole of $\mathrm{Aut}^+(F_2)$ is open. The theorem is conditional on the three listed inputs and the stated reading of the surface, and *conditional* is the word: with $n = 0$, or without the triplet postulate, there is no count. B1641 also finds, by its sealed read-out, that the hand is *not* the puncture condition's orientation at the representation level: neither ρ_T nor its conjugate is a sub or quotient of L_6. It makes no claim about the hand (Section 8).

The end radius, and what fixes it. Proposition 16 introduced the end radius $\mathcal{E} = \log(1/\epsilon)$ of a disc removed at the puncture. B1656's channel norm is the regularised norm with $2\pi\mathcal{E}$ subtracted, and the first generation's lift $D/(2\pi\mathcal{E})$ depends on it. In the flat metric a complete cusp has no boundary on which to impose a condition, and $\mathcal{E}$ behaves as a free scale (B1654). In the fibre's own complete hyperbolic metric, the uniformisation of the punctured torus, the puncture is a hyperbolic cusp. A hyperbolic cusp has canonical neighbourhoods: the maximal embedded horoball, and the horocycle of length 2, which is embedded (B1667 checks this on its grid; Shimizu's lemma gives length 1). Each fixes $\mathcal{E}$ as a function of τ alone.

Census law 25 (the canonical cusp; B1667)**.** On a grid over the fundamental domain up to $\mathrm{Im}\,\tau = 4$ (54 points: 48 on the grid, 4 on a ray from ω and 2 controls), the maximal cusp gives $\mathcal{E}_{\max} \in [0.643, 0.692]$ and the horocycle of length 2 gives $\mathcal{E}_2 \in [2.29, 2.79]$. At $\tau = \omega$ (computed at $e^{i\pi/3}$, in the same orbit) both equal a closed form from the periods of η^4: the punctured hexagonal torus is $\mathbb{H}/\mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{Z})'$, freely generated by LR and RL. Under either canonical cut, the first generation's lift, computed with the exact channel norms outside the horoball, is a function of τ alone: 0.03 to 0.07 under the length-2 cut and 0.24 to 0.41 under the maximal cut, at the twelve bulk points. Under the length-2 cut it has a simple zero at ω and falls like $e^{-2.6\,\mathrm{Im}\,\tau}$ toward the cusp of moduli.

Under either cut the end therefore supplies no hierarchy on the sampled range: a large $\mathcal{E}$, which the bulk hierarchy $m_1/m_3 \approx 0.15/\mathcal{E}$ would need, is a cut far inside every canonical horoball, at

a scale the fibre's geometry does not supply. Under either of these two canonical cuts the end datum is fixed by τ, and a small first generation becomes a statement about τ. The computation is a census over the grid, informed by points seen before its seal. It does not say which canonical horocycle, if either, is the physical end, and it does not exclude other admissible ends.

Does the symmetry fix the domain? If the domain must be preserved by the moves, the freedom drops from a continuum to the invariant subspaces of L_6. By the proof above, $L_6 = V_2 \oplus V_4$ with V_2 and V_4 inequivalent and irreducible; the group the moves generate on L_6 is the binary octahedral group $2O$, of order 48 (B1606). So the invariant domains are $0, V_2, V_4, L_6$, and the index is ± 3 or ± 1 (the record's kept indices $-3, -1, +1, +3$, B1606). The symmetry therefore restricts the count but does not force three: an invariant domain of dimension three, which would leave only $-3, 0, +3$, does not exist, because L_6 has no three-dimensional constituent. If the end condition also keeps the parity grading, the group acts irreducibly on L_6 (order 192) and only 0 and L_6 remain, so the index is ± 3 (B1606). Whether the end must keep the grading is not derived, and the extreme domain remains a choice. On the even-word subgroup, the binary tetrahedral group $2T$ of order 24, the six coefficients split into three inequivalent doublets. The invariant domains then have dimensions $0, 2, 4, 6$ and the same indices $-3, -1, +1, +3$, and the graded case again leaves only ± 3 (B1609). Whether a finite-distance model of the puncture, whose index is also $\dim \Lambda - 3$, carries the same module is open.

Reading. The triplet is a representation until something counts it. What counts it is not in the grammar: one postulate says where the matter lives, one unit says how many times the end is taken, and one choice says which boundary domain is kept. A chiral three is thereby a question about the cusp's end, not a consequence of the moves.

7 The boundary

The question. The structure of the previous sections holds on the inputs of Table 1, and it fixes no number. The principle asks for more than structure: it would have to single out a world. This section asks how far the same structure reaches toward the Standard Model's flavour numbers, and where it stops. We answer with results of one kind, each stated with its frame and its grade: what the weave's symmetry, its clock, its frames and its motion do *not* fix. The results are labelled N1–N7. Four of them (N4–N7) are sealed negatives, a compiled verdict, or sealed scoreboards, and we keep them in the paper because a boundary located only by success would not be located. The program's arcs are cited by number (B1604 and so on) as the record, not as papers [2]. No result below is a value of the Standard Model (0 of 19).

The spine. A law of invariance fixes an orbit, not a point of it: a selector that commutes with a group acting on the possible numbers cannot choose among the points of one orbit (the record's orbit-to-point gap, B990, stated there for orbits of pairs of 27s). At a point of the fibre the residue coupling has rank one and the coupling has rank at most two for every flat line (B1653); at the symmetric point $\tau = \omega$ the Higgs's symmetric vacua give masses $(1, 1, 0)$, a rank-one coupling, or a hierarchy set by the two defects (B1657), and the isotropic vacua carry no hierarchy of their own. Hence whatever chooses the numbers is not a symmetry, although it acts at one. N1–N4 below are the symmetry side of this statement; N5–N7 are the quantitative side, on the matter and the motion.

7.1 No index on a thread

Theorem 26 (N1; B1604)**.** *Let N be the interior of a compact 3-manifold with torus boundary (a cusped hyperbolic 3-manifold, or a finite cover of one), and let E be any flat module. Then*

$$\chi(N; E) = \chi(N, \partial N; E) = \operatorname{rank}(E)\, \chi(N) = 0,$$

because $\chi(N) = \frac{1}{2}\chi(\partial N) = 0$. *By Poincaré–Lefschetz duality* $h^2(N;E) = \dim H^1(N, \partial N; E^*)$ *and* $h^3(N;E) = 0$. *The class index* $I(E) = n(E) - n(E^*)$, *where* $n(E)$ *is the dimension of the interior cohomology, the image of* $H^1(N, \partial N; E) \to H^1(N;E)$, *and* $n(E^*)$ *equals, by duality, the interior dimension of* E *in degree two, is therefore not an Euler characteristic, and no index theorem of Euler type computes it.*

Scope. This is standard topology (the vanishing of χ on odd-dimensional manifolds, and duality) applied to the record's class index; the application is the arc's. The consequence is the one we use: a generation count obtained as a flat-module index on a thread, or on a cover of one, is not given by an Euler-type index theorem; this argument does not exclude other index constructions. The record also finds, by computation on the modules it checked, that $I(\Lambda^2 E)$ is not a function of $I(E)$ (B1603). A physical count needs an even-dimensional object with a non-flat bundle, or else "a generation" means a sector selected by a character, which is a selection. This is why the chiral three of Section 6 is stated with three inputs and a reading, and not as a consequence of the thread alone.

7.2 Residual symmetries against the data

Theorem 27 (N2; B1620, B1625)**.** *Let* G *be the weave's group (the lifts of* L *and* R *on* $V = T \oplus \bar{T}$*; order* 96*, faithful and irreducible on the triplet* T*). Take every subgroup* $H \leq G$ *(*68 *subgroups in* 26 *classes) as the residual symmetry of one sector, none chosen.*

1. *A sector has three distinct masses exactly when* $T|_H$ *is a sum of three characters, that is when* H *is abelian (*57 *of the* 68*), and every such residual leaves the masses free.*

2. *For every ordered pair of such residuals the family of mixing matrices has dimension* $0, 1, 2, 3$ *or* 4 *(the rank of the map to the nine* $|V_{ij}|^2$ *and the Jarlskog invariant), and no family of dimension below* 4 *reaches the CKM matrix at* 3σ*.*

3. *This holds with the mass term in* $\bar{T} \otimes T$*, in* $T \otimes T$ *and in* $\mathrm{Sym}^2 T$ *(with* 57*,* 24 *and* 16 *viable subgroups), and in every frame on record where the inner automorphisms act.*

Scope. Proved by exhaustive computation over the subgroups and the three tensors; the block test used for the CKM bound is necessary and sample-free, while the reach of the PMNS matrix is decided by a fit (and was regraded with a strict predicate in B1625, the minimum unchanged). The statement is scoped, as the record scopes it, to the frames where the inner automorphisms act; on the ruled branch the count is a lower bound under the modular-flavour ansatz. For couplings in the modulus τ alone, the inner automorphisms generate an abelian group of order four that splits T into three lines with distinct characters, so every mixing is a permutation (B1620). Whether the statement for this particular group is already known is open: we are not aware of a published discrete-flavour model that reduces the thirteen by a definite number [22, 1].[1]

7.3 The clock stays in the grading

Theorem 28 (N3; B1621, B1633)**.** *Let the clock be the parity class* (A_n, B_n) *modulo* 2 *of the rule's fixed-point word, acting on* T *as conjugation by the word's prefix, which is* $\mathrm{diag}(\chi_p)$ *on* T*.*

1. *The clock's matrices span exactly the diagonal algebra. Every coupling that reads the clock is diagonal in the parity lines under every tensor: it splits masses and never mixes, and its invariant mean on* T *is zero.*

[1] A fourth boundary statement, a count of the parameters that one-modulus modular fits need (B1637), is not stated here. Its near-cusp fits were artifacts of the evaluator's precision, and its re-run on an accurate evaluator is owed.

2. *The tick $\sigma^2 = LR$ acts on T with eigenvalues $\{1, \omega, \omega^2\}$ and cycles the parity lines. Its operator mean is the rank-one democratic matrix, which does not commute with the clock, and its means on the clock's forms give three equal masses under all three tensors.*

3. *The averaged word coupling is a scalar on T (B1633).*

Scope. Exact up to floating point, with the word taken to F_{30}. The democratic matrix is classical; the statement that it is a mean and not a commutant leaves the earlier refutation of $\mathbb{Z}/3$-forced democracy untouched. The consequence is that the principle's own data (its clock and its tick) fix no number: they supply a grading and a scalar.

7.4 The frame tribunal

The same computation gave different answers in different frames: the first-generation zero holds in one and dies in another, and "the Higgs in M" is the electroweak Higgs in one frame and a flavon in another. A value can be derived only along a chain with no hidden choice, and the frame is the first link of every chain, so the frames were judged before further numbers were chased.

Proposition 29 (N4; B1652)**.** *Take the frames on record (F1, the fibre at one τ; F2, the surface frame with τ integrated; F3, an E_8 frame studied within the program; F4, the thread frame) and the eight demands D1–D8: the moves act as symmetries; the chiral three; an anomaly-free hypercharge; an electroweak Higgs that couples the matter; a possible hierarchy; no free number beyond the tagged postulates; CP violation possible; the scale and gravity. Then no frame on record is shown to satisfy the demands on its own. The parent that would satisfy all of them is a seven-clause specification, and it is a conjecture.*

Scope. A compiled verdict on the record's evidence of 2026-10-14, with each cell graded and cited. "Shown" means shown by a computation reproduced in the record; cells resting on an unreproduced computation are read and not built on, and the verdict needs only the verified failures and the untested cells. Representative cells, not the table: F1 holds the chiral three given the triplet postulate and allows CP violation, but its hierarchy needs a free number per sector and its D1 holds only given a vacuum that no dynamics on record selects; F2 holds the moves but needs a source from outside the weave for the three and forbids CP violation; F3 holds the moves only by a supplied completion that, on its flat background, loses the weak roots and the hypercharge, and its physical index is not computed. A further candidate, formed inside the program, was refuted by the record (it fails D2 and D4 on the data) and is not counted. The scope note on F3 applies: the table is evidence that no exhibited frame discharges every demand, not that every frame fails.

7.5 One Higgs against the data: a scoreboard

Census law 30 (N5; B1660; a scoreboard, negative as sealed)**.** On none of the eighteen admissible lines at the symmetric point $\tau = \omega$, in none of three readings of the up sector (the same coupling S, the coupling $\tilde{S} = \epsilon \bar{S} \epsilon^T$, and the conjugate $\bar{S}$), does a single Higgs reproduce the data's five non-electron mass ratios: no fit was found below the conservative bound $\chi^2 = 11.07$ (the 95% point of χ^2 with five degrees of freedom; the minimum over the fit's parameters is at most the value at the true point, so the bound is one-sided and conservative), and the best was 34.40 (the conjugate reading on the pair of lines $(p_1, p_2) = (1/9, 7/9)$ and $(8/9, 2/9)$, with $w = p_1\tau - p_2$).

Scope. A scoreboard, not a blind test: the data [27] were seen. The census is for the canonical end condition and the twisted frame of Section 5, at $\tau = \omega$, and the search was shown to recover planted worlds in the data's regime. The end radius was a free parameter of the fit,

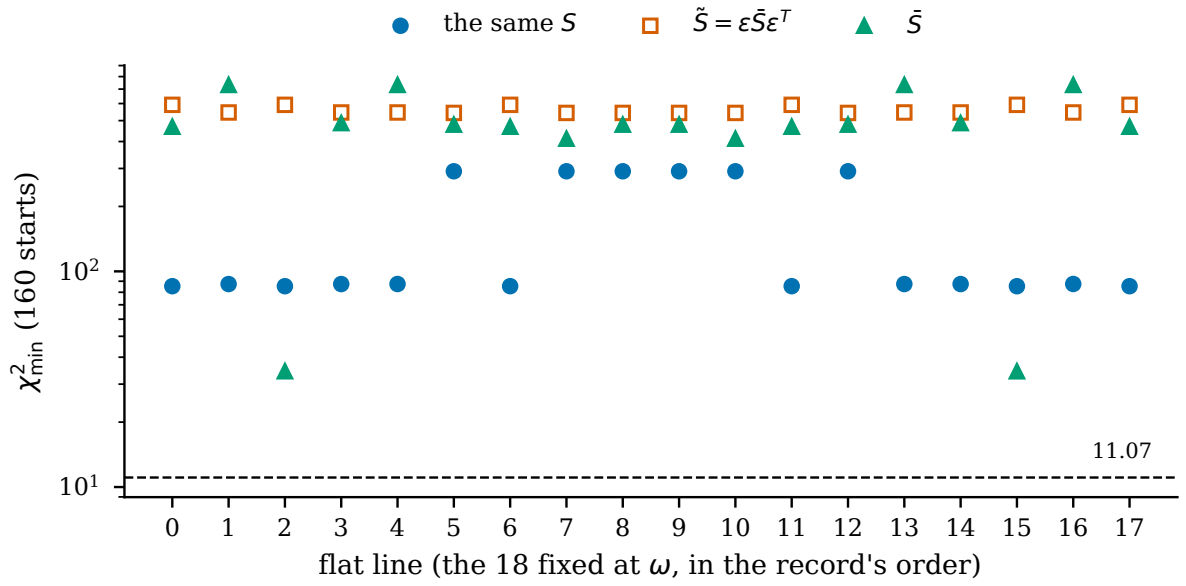


Figure 5: B1660's scoreboard. The best χ^2 (160 starts) on each of the eighteen admissible lines in each of three readings of the up sector, against the conservative bound 11.07. Scope: one Higgs at $\tau = \omega$ on the admissible lines, the data seen; a scoreboard, not a ceiling, and not a statement about two Higgs fields.

over a domain ($2\pi\mathcal{E} + c_s > 0.5$ in every channel, unbounded above) that contains both canonical radii at ω (Census law 25: 0.692 and 2.786), so the canonical radii are among the values the fit could take. Its starts had $\mathcal{E} \geq 2.5$, and the lift with the exact norms outside a horoball differs from B1654's form by 17 to 25 per cent (B1667). The end radius is a free parameter of the search, so the best value found bounds the best fit from above only. The census therefore does not by itself certify the result at a fixed radius, such as the canonical cuts of Census law 25. The misses are the two middle ratios, m_s/m_b too large and m_μ/m_τ too small. The data put $(m_\mu/m_\tau)/(m_s/m_b)$ at 3.14, against 0.63–1.75 at the best points of the census (Figure 5); the up quarks' m_1/m_3 is met. The Georgi–Jarlskog relation between the down quarks' and the leptons' middle masses [30] is context, not a claim.

Two post-seal explorations bound what the negative means, and both are labelled as explorations. First, there is no ceiling: with no other target, the ratio $(m_\mu/m_\tau)/(m_s/m_b)$ reaches between 9 and 34 over every Higgs and every end radius on four lines, so the misfit is a joint conflict among the five targets and not a bound on one of them. Second, without the up quarks the down and lepton targets fit exactly. A second Higgs for the up quarks therefore makes the ratios fittable, which is why it needs a blind test and not a further scoreboard.

7.6 The pull-back's strength

The grammar's states move: a walk of steps and their pull-backs escapes at a positive rate whatever the pull-back's strength (for the symmetric walk by Kesten [6] and Furstenberg [7]; for the other weights by the same theorem of Furstenberg, as the support generates $\mathrm{SL}(2,\mathbb{Z})$; the rates are measured here). We call the pull-back's weight p (the probability of choosing a pull-back at each step). The question is which quantities the weight p sets.

Census law 31 (N6; B1663; negative as sealed)**.** For $p = 0, 0.1, \ldots, 0.5$ the walk on L, R, L^{-1}, R^{-1} (equal weights within each pair) has the following behavior.

1. The probability that the end lies on the positive side falls from 1.000 at $p = 0$ to 0.531 ± 0.028 at $p = \frac{1}{2}$ ($\frac{1}{2}$ exactly there, by the mirror).

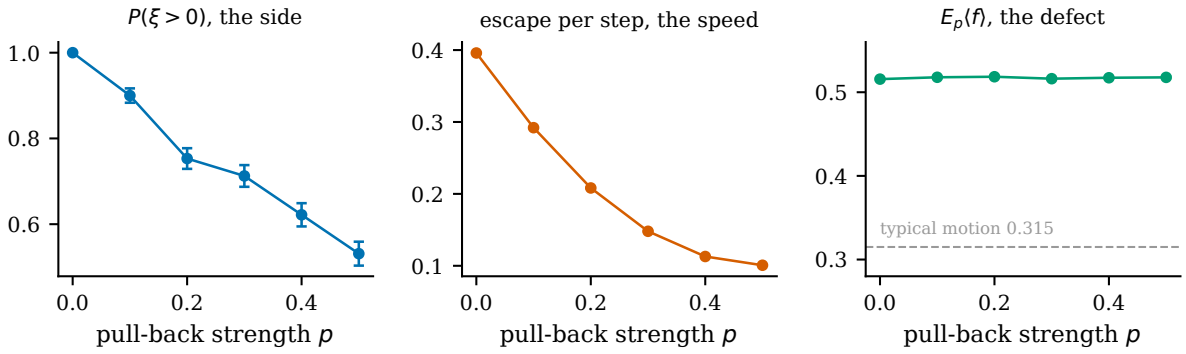


Figure 6: B1663. (a) The side $P(\xi > 0)$, (b) the escape rate and (c) the averaged defect $\langle f \rangle$ against the pull-back weight p, with the typical motion's 0.31500491 marked. Scope: the walk on $L^{\pm 1}, R^{\pm 1}$ with equal weights within each pair; the flat panel (c) is the negative result, and its resolution is about 0.009.

2. The escape rate falls from 0.3959 ± 0.0004 per step at $p = 0$ to 0.1007 ± 0.0005 at $p = \frac{1}{2}$.
3. The motion's averaged defect $\langle f \rangle$ is 0.5157 ± 0.0012 at $p = 0$ and 0.5178 ± 0.0013 at $p = \frac{1}{2}$; over all six values of p it varies by 0.0028. The preregistered prediction that it would differ by more than five standard errors failed.

Scope. The statement is for L, R and their inverses with equal weights within each pair, with resolution about 0.009: a mild dependence of that size is not excluded. The averaged defect is a definite number, 0.517, the forward motion's; it differs from 0.31500491, the average of f over the modular surface, which is the value along a typical geodesic (the *typical motion's* value), and no dictionary attaches it to a mass. The strength p sets the side and the speed. It does not set the defect, so the pull-back adds no number to the sizes.

A post-seal exploration, labelled, bears on why. The continued-fraction digits of the limit follow the geometric law 2^{-k} at $p = 0$ and at $p = \frac{1}{2}$ alike (frequencies $0.502, 0.248, 0.123, 0.064$ and $0.504, 0.253, 0.121, 0.060$ for the digits 1 to 4, on 24 000 digits each), against the Gauss–Kuzmin law $0.415, 0.170, 0.093, 0.059$ of a typical point. At $p = 0$ the geometric law is exact and classical: the steps are fair independent letters, the digits are their run lengths, and the limit's law is Minkowski's measure $d?(x)$, which is singular [31, 32]. The $p = 0$ reading is therefore a control. At $p = \frac{1}{2}$ the same law is a reading of 24 000 digits and not a proof. For $p > 0$ the steps generate the group, and the exit law of a finitely supported generating walk is singular: for $\mathrm{SL}(2, \mathbb{Z})$ by [33], and for nonuniform lattices in general by [34]. We use neither statement beyond that scope.

7.7 The layers

The weave has two sides, the sum over closed geodesics (the threads) and the spectrum of the modular surface (the waves). We asked what the threads' layers do on the program's own quantity, the matter's defect D with $f = |D|/\|\rho\|^2$. The sequence of arcs is part of the result. B1664 and B1665 were sealed and failed their own gate at the two zeros of D (Section 9); both are recorded as inconclusive. B1666 re-sealed the test with an estimator that no zero can spoil; its cells hold, and it is a sealed scoreboard, because the read-outs of the first two were seen.

The period phase is Theorem 22, which holds for every thread (checked to trace 600, Census law 23): a coherent average of the amplitude survives only on the quarter of threads with $\#L \equiv \#R \pmod 4$. The layers then give the following.

Census law 32 (N7; B1664–B1666; a scoreboard)**.** To trace 600, and on the threads of that range:

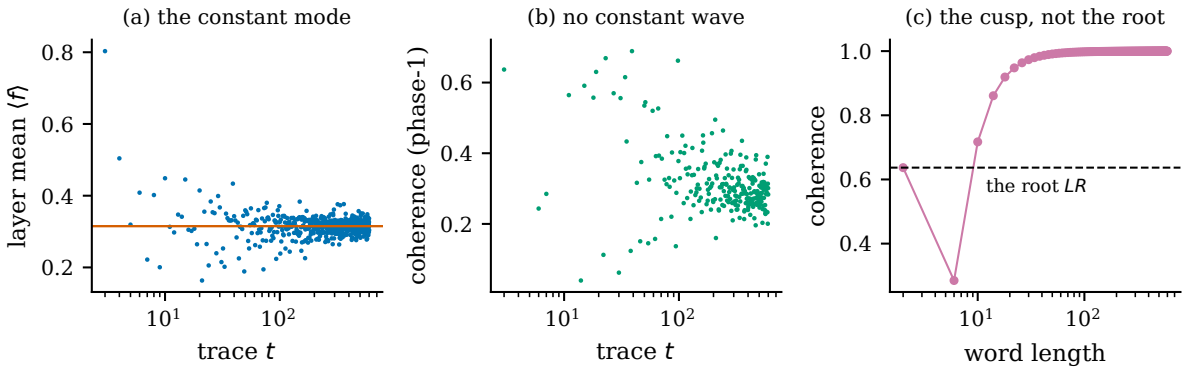


Figure 7: B1666. (a) The layer averages of f against the trace t, approaching the constant 0.31500491. (b) The layer mean of the phase-one coherence against the trace t. (c) The cusp family $L^{4m+1}R$ against word length, with the root LR marked. Scope: traces at most 600, 30 674 threads, and the matter's defect D alone; a scoreboard.

1. the layer averages of f by trace approach the typical motion's 0.31500491 (the top quarter of the traces, 451 to 600, gives 0.3144, against 0.3692 for traces at most 20), with the distance falling as $t^{-0.51\pm0.05}$;

2. the phase-one coherence of the amplitude falls with length, with slope -0.269 ± 0.083 (3.2 standard errors), slower than a random phase would give $(-\frac{1}{2})$;

3. the coherent rule favours the cusp family $L^{4m+1}R$: after a first drop its coherence climbs toward one (0.637 at LR, then $0.285, 0.717, 0.861, 0.919, 0.948, \ldots, 0.99994$), and the most coherent phase-one thread is the longest of the family. The root LR is not singled out. This is a read-out with no criterion, and the size of the coherent amplitude is not compared;

Scope. Item 1 is the trace formula's constant mode on the program's own quantity, expected from the equidistribution of closed geodesics on the modular surface and of their discriminant layers [28, 29], with cycle integrals as in [35]; it is a check of the weave side against the wave side, not a new equidistribution theorem. The law of the phase is a sealed identity; items 1–3 are a scoreboard (the earlier read-outs were seen). What it does not show: the physical amplitude (this is D alone, and the physical amplitude needs the Higgs's own law), any Standard Model value, or the rate of approach as a law. The approach to the constant mode is a property of bounded quantities such as f; it is not claimed for quantities that grow at the cusp.

Reading. The boundary has a shape. What the weave's symmetry, its clock and its frames fix is the structure and none of the numbers, and each attempt to let a motion choose the numbers returns a constant: the pull-back's strength changes the speed and not the size; the threads' averages return the surface's own constant; and the one place the motion prefers something (the coherent rule) it prefers the cusp, where the defect vanishes. This is a reading of Sections 7 and 8 together, and it states no result.

8 The open problem: selection

The question. Section 7 located what the structure leaves free. Here we list the free "which" choices, state the shape that a principle selecting among them would have to take, and stop. We do not propose such a principle. Every statement in this section that is not a cited result of an earlier section is a question.

Every "which" is free. Each of the following is supplied, not derived, in every frame on record.

- The modulus τ: with the Higgs along ρ, the record's invariant quartic selects $\tau = \omega$ or runs to the cusp, and neither carries a hierarchy (B1652); the record's check covers that direction only.
- The direction of the Higgs in the triplet's space: it is the second-to-third mass matrix (a bijection onto the symmetric 2×2 matrices), and no constant direction is covariant under the moves (Section 5).
- The line, that is the flat hypercharge line of a sector, among the eighteen admissible lines at $\tau = \omega$ (B1660).
- The vacuum, and the frame (Proposition 29).
- The side of the end at which the motion settles (B1663): the pull-back's strength sets which end and how fast, and the choice of side is the positivity of the earlier foundation, now read as a choice.
- The choice of canonical horocycle at the puncture, which fixes the end radius $\mathcal{E}$ at order one; the choice is discrete, and the record does not make it (Census law 25, B1667).

These choices are not counted in the record's price, four axioms and nine irreducible identifications for the whole chain. No residual symmetry of the weave's group that reduces the count is compatible with the CKM data at 3σ (Theorem 27).

The shape of a selection principle. Two proved statements constrain it. First, an invariant selector fixes an orbit, not a point of it (B990), and the symmetric points of the modulus carry rank-one couplings or a hierarchy set by data the symmetry does not fix (B1653, B1657). Symmetry and orbit invariants alone therefore cannot select a point that is not fixed; an invariant dynamics with a symmetry-breaking vacuum is not excluded. A selection principle must act where the symmetry is broken or at its fixed points. Second, the clock and the tick supply a grading and a scalar and nothing else (Theorem 28), and the pull-back's strength supplies a side and a speed but no size (Census law 31). A principle that takes its input from either is not enough. What would be enough is stated by the demands of the tribunal: a dynamics on record and run that selects a vacuum, with the completion and the normalisation named among its inputs (Proposition 29).

Reading. The motion's facts, as fenced outlook. The coherent rule of the layers favours the cusp family, whose members climb toward full coherence, and not the root LR (Census law 32). Whether that preference selects anything depends on the physical amplitude, which this paper does not construct; we leave the question as stated.

Reading. The weave and the wave are the two sides of one equation. The Selberg trace formula equates a sum over the closed geodesics (the threads, by length) with a sum over the spectrum of the modular surface (the waves, by frequency), plus terms for the identity, the elliptic points and the cusp; the geometric side runs over the conjugacy classes that the grammar, with the pull-back, makes reachable states. The shape a selection principle would have to take is one that reads one side through the other. The layers' constant mode (Census law 32) is this equation's constant term seen on the program's own quantity. That physics lives on this is not shown.

9 Methods: how the record is kept

The question. A program that asks what is forced must show what it assumed and must show its errors. This section says how the record is kept and gives three corrections as examples. The repository holds every script, output and lock [2].

Sealed preregistration. A computation that bears on a claim is written as a preregistration before it is run. It has three parts:

- its cells, each a prediction with a criterion that can fail;
- a "seen first" section: a sweep of the record for prior work, so that no question is asked twice unknowingly, and the literature read;
- a "disclosed" section: everything known or explored before sealing, and any reviewing pass.

The preregistration and the instrument are hashed and committed. The instrument is then run once. Its output goes into its own commit, before the commit that holds any read-out. The history shows that order. That the output was not looked at in between is the authors' statement, which the history cannot show.

Results are graded by the preregistration's rule: a cell that holds, a cell that fails, or a cell that is an identity and cannot fail (reported apart from the tests). A result computed on data that were seen is a *scoreboard*, and its statement says so. Explorations after the seal are labelled and kept apart, with their outputs hashed. A later change to a sealed file is recorded the same day, in a form that the seal check reads.

Parallel lines and reproduction. The work is done on several parallel lines, each on its own branch. A result from one line enters the record as an arc only after it has been reproduced from its statement on the main line, in independently written code where possible. Results that were read and not re-run are marked so in the record. All verification described in this paper is internal to the program. None of it is external review.

Three corrections. Errors are recorded as classes and instances in a ledger; the classes this paper meets are listed in Appendix C. Three instances from the arcs reported here show the checks at work.

- **A read-out that outran its computation (B1660).** The first read-out of the one-Higgs census called the down–lepton miss an obstruction that a separate up-quark Higgs "does not touch", and implied a ceiling on $(m_\mu/m_\tau)/(m_s/m_b)$. Two checks after the seal found no ceiling, and an exact fit once the up quarks are dropped. The verdict line was corrected before the result entered the record. Two further faults in the findings were repaired at the next review: a step that did not follow, and a headline that rounded two misses.
- **A gate that failed at the function's zeros (B1664, B1665, B1666).** The gate asked for the period phase on every thread, read at one point of each period. The instrument set D to zero above height 50, and 593 of the 30 674 threads began their sampling there, so B1664 was recorded as open. B1665 moved each start to the period's lowest point. That point is the corner at ω, where D also vanishes, and the gate failed on 22 threads. The second repair had not been reviewed. B1666 replaced the one-point ratio by a least-squares phase over two consecutive periods, which no zero can spoil. Before the seal, a review checked it on about 2900 threads, including every thread of trace at least 560; the worst error was 1.1×10^{-7}, and the gate was set at 10^{-5} on that measurement. The sealed

run met the gate on all 30 674 threads. The rule taken from this: a ratio is never read at one point of a function with zeros, and every re-seal is reviewed, however small.

- **Checks that read the wrong thing (B1654, B1421).** In B1654, four review helpers read the instrument by an absolute path outside the repository. The repair made the paths relative and was noted, but not in the form that the seal check reads, so the check reported a disclosed repair as an undisclosed change. The note was recast. Separately, the full test suite found a lock (B1421) that still asserted an old count of irreducible inputs after the count had become $4 + 9 = 13$; the smaller suites run at each landing had missed it.

What the method does and does not give. It gives a record in which every computed statement has a script, a seal and a stated scope, and in which failures are kept. It does not give external verification. A statement graded "proved" here is proved by the program's own computation or by a cited theorem. The verification package of Appendix B lets a reader repeat the load-bearing computations.

10 What the principle forces, and what it leaves

This section is an essay. Its sentences are marked: those about mathematics are statements of the preceding sections, and those about meaning are readings.

Forced existence. We started from one sentence, that existence is what remains when cancelling to nothing cannot complete, and read it as a grammar of records. The mathematics of the paper is what that reading forces. A first closed path that mixes the records is the figure-eight's monodromy, under four stated inputs (Theorem 2). Across all closed paths at once the moves permute the records' three parities, for every word, and carry a triplet, proved for every odd-trace word, with the arithmetic of its common point a census to length eight (Theorem 6). Up to a stated hand and a power of the eta character, the triplet's symmetry is the multiplier of a classical family of theta functions (Theorem 9). In the fibre frame and given the triplet postulate the couplings are isotropic at every point (Theorem 12); the product of the masses factors through two defects and their pairing (Theorem 20); and, given three stated inputs and a reading of the weave's surface, the triplet becomes a chiral three (Theorem 24). Nothing in this list was put in to make a number come out. Only its first statement holds for every thread at once; the later statements hold in one frame.

Unforced selection. What the same mathematics does not force is any of the choices that would single out a world (Section 8). We located each: no residual symmetry of the weave's group that reduces the count of flavour parameters is compatible with the CKM data at 3σ; its clock stays in a grading; no frame on record is shown to satisfy the principle's demands on its own; one Higgs at the symmetric point fits the five non-electron ratios on none of the admissible lines; and the strength of the pull-back sets a side and a speed and no size. The contrast is the paper's organising one. The structure is forced to exist. Which structure we are in is not.

Reading. A principle of existence that is minimal cannot also be a principle of selection, because selection would be an additional content. That the structure is forced and the "which" is not is what one would expect if existence were the remainder of cancelling, and a particular world were a reading of that remainder. The same boundary would also appear if the chosen form were not the principle's own, since the frames on record share the same postulated triplet and read-out. This is an interpretation of the boundary and not a consequence of it.

The push-back picture, as a question. One picture motivated this program from its start, and we record it as a question. In it, every step of the grammar is accompanied by its pull-back; the two are never at rest; and the interaction of the steps with their pull-backs, and not either alone, is what is real. The mathematics that bears on the picture is proved and is separate from it:

- the walk of steps and pull-backs escapes at a positive rate: for equal weights by the theorems of Kesten and Furstenberg, and at the other weights by Furstenberg's theorem, with the values measured (Census law 31);
- a full turn round a balance point of a step and its pull-back carries the sign (Section 2);
- the matter's amplitude along a thread returns by the Higgs's character, so a coherent average survives only on the quarter of threads with $\#L \equiv \#R \pmod 4$ (Theorem 22);
- the pull-back's strength fixes which end and how fast and adds no number to the sizes (Census law 31);
- the threads' averages approach the surface's constant mode, and the coherent rule favours the cusp (Census law 32).

The last two are a sealed negative and a sealed scoreboard, and none is a value (0 of 19). What is not shown is whether the pull-back is a force, whether the motion is time, whether the values are the motion, and which average the motion takes.

Reading. Is the universe a wave, a weave of threads, or both? In the mathematics the two are one object seen two ways: the threads are closed geodesics of the modular surface and the waves are its automorphic forms, and the trace formula equates the sum over the one with the sum over the other. Whether physics lives on this is a question. If it does, the question to ask next is the one of Section 8: what reads one side through the other, and with what amplitude.

What the program stands on. It stands on the structure of Sections 2–6, on the boundary of Section 7, and on its price, every input stated in Table 1. It does not stand on the readings.

A Three hand computations

Each computation below is short enough to check by hand.

Conventions. The records (a, b) are a row vector. The moves are the matrices

$$L = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right), \qquad R = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right),$$

acting on the right: $(a, b)L = (a, a + b)$ and $(a, b)R = (a + b, b)$. On the upper half-plane they act by Möbius transformations, $L : \tau \mapsto \tau + 1$ and $R : \tau \mapsto \tau/(\tau + 1)$. These are the matrices of the record's locks.

A.1 Jacobi isotropy

The theta triplet of Section 5 is $\rho = (-\theta_2^2,\ -\theta_4^2,\ i\theta_3^2)/(2\pi\eta^3)$, with $\theta_r = \theta_r(0, \tau)$, paired by the form $x \cdot x = x_1^2 + x_2^2 + x_3^2$. Then

$$\rho \cdot \rho = \frac{\theta_2^4 + \theta_4^4 - \theta_3^4}{(2\pi\eta^3)^2} = 0$$

by Jacobi's identity $\theta_3^4 = \theta_2^4 + \theta_4^4$ [19], so ρ is isotropic.

Hence for a single-point coupling $Y(a) = a\rho^T + \rho a^T - (a \cdot \rho)\mathbb{1}$,

$$Y(a)\rho = (\rho \cdot \rho)\, a + (a \cdot \rho)\, \rho - (a \cdot \rho)\, \rho = 0,$$

and likewise $\rho^T Y(a) = 0$. The theta triplet is a two-sided null vector: one generation is massless at leading order (Theorem 12).

A.2 The commutator and the sign

Take $A = LR = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, the root, and $B = RL = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$. Then

$$ABA^{-1}B^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} -7 & 6 \\ -6 & 5 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \operatorname{tr} = -2.$$

The matrix is $-U$ with $U = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 7 & -6 \\ 6 & -5 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ unipotent ($\operatorname{tr} U = 2$, $U \neq \mathbb{1}$). Changing the sign of A or of B does not change the commutator. The attempt to cancel, two steps followed by their pull-backs, lands on the cusp with the sign.

The sign is also a power of each balance-point rotation:

$$LR^{-1}L = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad (LR^{-1}L)^2 = -\mathbb{1}; \qquad L^{-1}R = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad (L^{-1}R)^3 = -\mathbb{1}.$$

$LR^{-1}L$ fixes i and $L^{-1}R$ fixes $\omega = e^{2\pi i/3}$. Neither can be written with L and R alone: a determinant-one matrix with non-negative entries has trace 2 or at least 3, never 0 or ± 1, and is never $-\mathbb{1}$.

A.3 The multiplier of D on the moves

The matter's defect D has weight -1 and the multiplier χ of η^6 (Lemma 21). From $\eta(\tau+1) = e^{2\pi i/24}\eta(\tau)$ and $\eta(-1/\tau) = \sqrt{-i\tau}\,\eta(\tau)$:

$$\eta^6(\tau+1) = i\,\eta^6(\tau), \qquad \eta^6(-1/\tau) = (-i\tau)^3\eta^6(\tau) = i\,\tau^3\eta^6(\tau).$$

So $\chi(L) = i$ for $L : \tau \mapsto \tau + 1$, and $\chi(S_0) = i$ for $S_0 = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$.

The second move is $R = S_0 L^{-1} S_0^{-1}$. To check: $S_0 L^{-1} = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, and multiplying by $S_0^{-1} = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ gives $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right) = R$. Since χ is a character, $\chi(R) = \chi(L)^{-1} = -i$.

A thread whose word has $\#L$ letters L and $\#R$ letters R therefore has $\chi = i^{\#L - \#R}$: the period phase of Theorem 22. The record's numerical checks of D's law at L, R, S_0 and $L^{-1}R$ (to 10^{-30}) agree.

B The verification package

Every boundary claim of the paper maps to an arc of the record, a lock (a test in the repository's suite), and a script. The repository is [2]; the table lists the claims whose scripts a reader should re-run. A planned single command, `make verify`, re-runs the load-bearing claims; at the time of drafting it is planned and not built. The figure scripts exist, one per figure, in the paper's source tree. The data figures (5, 6, 7) read the record's committed outputs and check them by hash. Figures 3 and 4 recompute from the stated formulas and the sealed instrument's function, and the chain and the seed's grid are drawn or closed-form, as their captions say. The scripts and the paper's sources are in the repository (`papers/P9_what_a_grammar_fixes`); a tagged release and an archival snapshot will be made at submission.

Grades are those of the record's registry. A seal check compares each sealed file to its recorded hash and reports any change not disclosed in the form it reads. The environment is pinned in the repository. All verification is internal to the program (Section 9); a reader's own run is the first external check.

C The corrections ledger

The ledger lists corrections relevant to the paper's claims, with the class of error, what was repaired and the rule that follows. It is a selection from the repository's error ledger and is not complete. The classes are named by the ledger's codes:

- E65: a frame or a reading adopted before the fact that decides it has been computed;
- E74: a preregistered rule that is itself mis-derived and then binds;
- E80: a verification rooted outside the repository;
- E82: a criterion that cannot fail on its domain, presented as a test.

All dates are in 2026.

References

[1] P. P. Novichkov, J. T. Penedo, and S. T. Petcov. Double cover of modular S_4 for flavour model building. *Nucl. Phys. B*, 963:115301, 2021.

[2] origin-axiom. The origin-axiom record: preregistrations, instruments, outputs and locks. public repository, 2026. tagged release and DOI snapshot at submission.

[3] Caroline Series. The modular surface and continued fractions. *J. London Math. Soc. (2)*, 31:69–80, 1985.

[4] William M. Goldman. The modular group action on real SL(2)-characters of a one-holed torus. *Geom. Topol.*, 7:443–486, 2003.

[5] Yair N. Minsky. The classification of punctured-torus groups. *Ann. of Math. (2)*, 149:559–626, 1999.

[6] Harry Kesten. Symmetric random walks on groups. *Trans. Amer. Math. Soc.*, 92:336–354, 1959.

[7] Harry Furstenberg. Noncommuting random products. *Trans. Amer. Math. Soc.*, 108:377–428, 1963.

[8] H. Furstenberg and H. Kesten. Products of random matrices. *Ann. Math. Statist.*, 31:457–469, 1960.

[9] Duncan A. Buell. *Binary Quadratic Forms: Classical Theory and Modern Computations*. Springer, 1989.

[10] Robert Riley. A quadratic parabolic group. *Math. Proc. Cambridge Philos. Soc.*, 77:281–288, 1975.

[11] William P. Thurston. The geometry and topology of three-manifolds, 1979. Princeton lecture notes, 1979.

[12] John Milnor. *Introduction to Algebraic K-Theory*. Number 72 in Annals of Mathematics Studies. Princeton University Press, 1971.

[13] Étienne Ghys. Knots and dynamics. In *Proceedings of the International Congress of Mathematicians, Madrid 2006*, volume I, pages 247–277. European Mathematical Society, 2007.

[14] Richard Moeckel. Geodesics on modular surfaces and continued fractions. *Ergodic Theory Dynam. Systems*, 2:69–83, 1982.

[15] Ernest Ma and G. Rajasekaran. Softly broken A_4 symmetry for nearly degenerate neutrino masses. *Phys. Rev. D*, 64:113012, 2001.

[16] Guido Altarelli and Ferruccio Feruglio. Tri-bimaximal neutrino mixing from discrete symmetry in extra dimensions. *Nucl. Phys. B*, 720:64–88, 2005.

[17] Fred Diamond and Jerry Shurman. *A First Course in Modular Forms*. Number 228 in Graduate Texts in Mathematics. Springer, 2005.

[18] Xiang-Gan Liu, Chang-Yuan Yao, and Gui-Jun Ding. Modular invariant quark and lepton models in double covering of S_4 modular group. *Phys. Rev. D*, 103:056013, 2021.

[19] E. T. Whittaker and G. N. Watson. *A Course of Modern Analysis*. Cambridge University Press, 4th edition, 1927. ch. XXI.

[20] L. Alvarez-Gaumé, G. Moore, and C. Vafa. Theta functions, modular invariance, and strings. *Commun. Math. Phys.*, 106:1–40, 1986.

[21] Richard E. Borcherds. Reflection groups of Lorentzian lattices. *Duke Math. J.*, 104(2):319–366, 2000.

[22] Ferruccio Feruglio. Are neutrino masses modular forms? In *From My Vast Repertoire: The Legacy of Guido Altarelli*. World Scientific, 2019.

[23] P. P. Novichkov, J. T. Penedo, and S. T. Petcov. Fermion mass hierarchies, large lepton mixing and residual modular symmetries. *JHEP*, 04:206, 2021.

[24] D. Cremades, L. E. Ibáñez, and F. Marchesano. Computing Yukawa couplings from magnetized extra dimensions. *JHEP*, 05:079, 2004.

[25] Tatsuo Kobayashi and Shintaro Tamba. Modular forms of finite modular subgroups from magnetized D-brane models. *Phys. Rev. D*, 99:046001, 2019.

[26] Carlos T. Simpson. Harmonic bundles on noncompact curves. *J. Amer. Math. Soc.*, 3:713–770, 1990.

[27] Guo-yuan Huang and Shun Zhou. Precise values of running quark and lepton masses in the Standard Model. *Phys. Rev. D*, 103:016010, 2021.

[28] W. Duke. Hyperbolic distribution problems and half-integral weight Maass forms. *Invent. Math.*, 92:73–90, 1988.

[29] Peter Sarnak. Class numbers of indefinite binary quadratic forms. *J. Number Theory*, 15:229–247, 1982.

[30] H. Georgi and C. Jarlskog. A new lepton-quark mass relation in a unified theory. *Phys. Lett. B*, 86:297–300, 1979.

[31] Arnaud Denjoy. Sur une fonction réelle de Minkowski. *J. Math. Pures Appl. (9)*, 17:105–151, 1938.

[32] Raphaël Salem. On some singular monotonic functions which are strictly increasing. *Trans. Amer. Math. Soc.*, 53:427–439, 1943.

[33] Y. Guivarc'h and Y. Le Jan. Asymptotic winding of the geodesic flow on modular surfaces and continuous fractions. *Ann. Sci. École Norm. Sup. (4)*, 26(1):23–50, 1993. Erratum: Ann. Sci. ENS (4) 29 (1996) 811–814.

[34] Vaibhav Gadre, Joseph Maher, and Giulio Tiozzo. Word length statistics and Lyapunov exponents for Fuchsian groups with cusps. *New York J. Math.*, 21:511–531, 2015.

[35] Svetlana Katok and Peter Sarnak. Heegner points, cycles and Maass forms. *Israel J. Math.*, 84:193–227, 1993.

Table 1: The inputs ledger. Status words follow the record: *postulated*, *chosen* (a selection), *adopted* (a ruling made on the mathematics), *tagged* (a working postulate whose results carry "given").

input	status	what it buys	what would discharge it
PF1–PF3, the principle	postulated	the question: what a non-cancelling description forces	none in the record
the grammar, GM1–GM5a	postulated (GM3 cheap; GM4's puncture conditional)	the moves, the threads, the carrier	none; GM1 is not independent of GM4
SE1, torsion-free first homology	postulated	the root among the states	alternatives are kept: minimal trace, minimal volume
SE2, orientation	chosen	the orientable root, and the sheet that carries the hand	a derived reason for orientability, or carrying both $m004$ and $m000$
GM5b, the pull-back acts	adopted, as a reading of PF1's cancelling	the sign $-I$ and a motion with no preferred side at equal strength; not needed for the root	not a derivation
positivity, as the side	chosen (a selection)	one side of the mirror: forward words	a reason for the side; what CP violation would read
the triplet postulate	tagged	left-handed matter in the triplet T; the mass tensor	a derivation of which fields carry T (the dictionary), or an obstruction; an index for the count does not pay it
one cusp unit	tagged	the index ± 3 (Section 6)	an end mechanism at the cusp
the extreme boundary domain	chosen	$\lvert\Lambda_+\rvert \in \{0, 6\}$, so ± 3 rather than ± 1 (Section 6)	a rule that selects the domain
$M_{1,2}$ as the weave's surface	a reading, verified in part	the setting of the index and of the zero modes	coherence of the lifts (a gate still open)
the vacuum-grading rule (demand D1, Section 7)	a ruling of the program	how a symmetry broken by a vacuum is graded	none
the end condition at the puncture	chosen	the norm of the boundary class, the electron's zero, the symmetric point's law and the census N5 (Section 5)	an end mechanism at the puncture; the fibre's hyperbolic metric fixes the end radius at order one (Census law 25), so a discrete choice remains
$\tau = \omega$ with the eighteen flat lines	chosen (a selection, Section 8)	the electron's zero, the symmetric point and the census N5	a rule that selects the modulus and the lines
equal framed data	chosen	the twisted half bound	a reason that the sectors' framed data are equal
the index as the generation count	identification	reads the index ± 3 of Section 6 as three generations	an index theorem on a physical spacetime
the read-out and the hypercharge dictionary	identifications	singular values as masses, flat-line twists as hypercharges and the Higgs line as the electroweak Higgs, with $6Y$ the minimal integral normalisation, itself a choice (Sections 5, 7)	a derivation of the dictionary
the fibre frame (the Higgs a section on the fibre, at one τ)	chosen (see Proposition 29)	the couplings of Section 5	a frame shown to meet the demands
the modulus $\tau = \omega$ and the eighteen flat lines	chosen	the electron's zero, the one-Higgs census (Sections 5, 7)	a rule that selects the modulus and the lines
the Higgs's type and locus (a point or density Higgs, at the puncture)	stated	the covariance theorem and the rank of a point coupling (Section 5)	a Higgs of another type, or a derived locus
the canonical end condition at the puncture, and the choice of canonical horocycle	chosen (discrete; the radius is of order one)	the first generation's lift (Sections 5, 6)	a reason for one horocycle

claim	arc	lock, script
N1: no index on a thread	B1604	tests/test_b1604_the_class_index_is_
N2: residual symmetries against the CKM matrix	B1620, B1625	tests/test_b1620_the_breaking_the_we
N3: the clock stays in the grading	B1621, B1633	tests/test_b1621_the_principles_cloc
N4: the frame tribunal	B1652	arc's verification/main_tribunal_checks.p
N5: one-Higgs census	B1660	tests/test_b1660_ the_one_higgs_ census.py; arc's verification/the_one_higgs_census.p output in its own commit
N6: the pull-back's strength	B1663	tests/test_b1663_ the_pull_backs_ strength.py; arc's verification/the_pull_backs_strengt
N7: the layers, the period phase	B1666 (B1664, B1665)	tests/test_b1666_the_layers_robust.p

Table 2: Boundary claims, with the arc, the lock and the script. Theorems T1–T7 follow the same pattern and are listed in the repository's theorem registry.

arc	class	found	what happened and the repair	rule
B1604 and others	E82	internal audit, Oct. 15	a lock ended in `or True`, and cells that could not fail were shown as tests; the lock now asserts the twenty threads' tiers, and B1655 lists the cells	a cell that cannot fail is sealed as an identity; a lock ends in a clause that can fail
B1620	E65	Oct. 9	the first row said "the TM type" under the first two tensors; corrected in B1625 (TM1 under $\bar{T} \otimes T$ only, TM2 under $T \otimes T$)	state the tensor with the type
B1637	evaluator	internal audit	near-cusp fits were artifacts of the evaluator; withdrawn; the re-run on an accurate evaluator is owed	no figure from B1637's data until the re-run
B1654	E80	periodic review, Oct. 16	four review helpers read the instrument by an absolute path outside the repository; the repair note recast in the seal check's form and the files named	a repair to a sealed file is recorded in the seal check's form the same day
B1660	E65	Oct. 16	a read-out narrowed before it was computed (an "obstruction" and a ceiling that post-seal checks did not find); verdict line corrected, findings repaired	compute the reach before naming an obstruction; separate pass criteria from expectations
B1664	E74	its own run	the gate failed on the instrument's cut-off (D set to zero above height 50; 593 of 30 674 threads); recorded as open	try the guard's region in the smoke test
B1665	E74	its own run	the repair moved the start to D's other zero (ω); 22 threads; recorded as open	never take a ratio at one point of a function with zeros; review every reseal
B1666	repair	review before the seal	a least-squares period phase over two periods; checked on about 2900 threads before the seal (worst error 1.1×10^{-7}), the gate set at 10^{-5} on that measurement; the sealed run met it on all 30 674	as above
B1421	stale lock	full suite, Oct. 16	the lock asserted 8 irreducible sources, the ledger's price is $4 + 9 = 13$; the lock asserts the live ledger	run the full suite after a ledger change

Table 3: This paper's corrections, drawn from the repository's error ledger and the findings of the arcs named.